Symmetry-Selected Nonlinear Thermal Pumping in Periodically Heated Mixed-Convection Channels

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Abstract

Nonlinear redistribution of wall heat flux in a two-dimensional laminar mixed-convection channel with spatially periodic wall heating of unequal amplitude is governed by an exact symmetry selection rule, while its magnitude and its direction are set by the coupled thermal and hydrodynamic dynamics. Decomposing the first-order thermal response into symmetric and antisymmetric components, we prove that their mixed quadratic interaction is odd across the channel, so that the second-order mean wall-flux corrections are equal and opposite; symmetry-preserving self-interactions produce no directional redistribution at the same order. The parity law defines a thermal-pumping coefficient obeying an exact Green-function identity, from which follow its linearity in the Grashof number, its quadratic suppression at long wavelength, and the independence of its zero from the buoyancy amplitude. Phase-shifted forcing adds a second, independent quadrature coefficient that can reverse the pumping on its own. A fully nonlinear direct numerical simulation converges to within 1.52% of the perturbative coefficient, returns the predicted reversal sign on both sides of the crossing at four wavenumbers, cancels the parity partner to nineteen decimals in the wall-flux difference, and tests the Grashof scaling at finite amplitude. The same thirteen-case campaign falsifies part of its own pre-registered error model: five of the twelve non-degenerate cases exceed the bound, by a deviation independent of the forcing amplitude and growing with the wavenumber. Symmetry selects the structure of the nonlinear redistribution; buoyancy-mediated dynamics select its amplitude, its sign, and the control parameter that governs it.

Keywords: mixed convection; streamwise-periodic wall heating; thermal pumping; symmetry selection rule; weakly nonlinear expansion; Reynolds-number reversal; direct numerical simulation; reproducibility

Nomenclature

Roman Symbols	
$A(k, Re, Pr)$	Normalized pumping response, $A = \Pi_T / Gr$ [-]
H	Channel half-width [m]
k	Dimensionless modulation wavenumber [-]
k^*	Zero of $\Pi_T(k, Pe)$ when an interior crossing exists [-]
Nu	Nusselt number [-]
p	Pressure [Pa]
Pe	Péclet number, $Pe = RePr$ [-]
Pr	Prandtl number, $Pr = \nu/\alpha$ [-]
Gr	Grashof number, $Gr = g\beta\Delta T H^3/\nu^2$ [-]
Re	Reynolds number, $Re = U_0 H/\nu$ [-]
U_0	Reference mean velocity used for nondimensionalization [m/s]
X, Y	Dimensionless streamwise and transverse coordinates [-]
Greek Symbols	
α	Thermal diffusivity [m^2/s]
β	Thermal expansion coefficient [K^{-1}]
$\varepsilon_1, \varepsilon_2$	Dimensionless wall-modulation amplitudes [-]
$\varepsilon_s, \varepsilon_a$	Symmetric and antisymmetric amplitudes [-]
θ	Dimensionless temperature perturbation [-]
ν	Kinematic viscosity [m^2/s]
Π_T	Normalized nonlinear thermal pumping coefficient [-]
ϕ	Phase shift between wall modulations [rad]
Abbreviations	
BC	Boundary condition
BVP	Boundary-value problem
IVP	Initial-value problem
RK	Runge–Kutta

1 Introduction

Two mechanisms are deliberately separated throughout this paper. Reflection *symmetry* selects the *structure* of the nonlinear redistribution of the wall heat flux: the second-order mean corrections at the two walls are exactly equal in magnitude and opposite in sign. The thermal–hydrodynamic *dynamics* select the *amplitude and the sign* of that redistribution, and at fixed Péclet number the Reynolds number controls the direction of the pumping. Every result below is assigned to one of these two categories, and the central claim of the paper is that the division is exact rather than rhetorical: the first statement holds as a theorem under stated assumptions, whereas the second requires quantitative calculation and can even reverse.

Mixed convection in vertical channels is a classical problem in which imposed shear and buoyancy interact to modify the velocity, temperature, and heat-transfer fields. Early

analyses established the fully developed theory and the possibility of buoyancy-induced flow reversal in vertical parallel- plate channels Aung and Worku (1986b,a); Hamadah and Wirtz (1991), while subsequent work considered asymmetric wall heating and its effect on the hydrodynamic and thermal response Aung and Worku (1987); Barletta (1998, 1999). These studies provide the mixed-convection foundation for the present analysis.

Spatially periodic thermal forcing introduces a separate mechanism: the wall temperature varies along the streamwise direction and generates thermal modes that interact with the base flow and, through buoyancy, with perturbation velocities. Periodically heated channels have been investigated both for natural convection and mixed convection, including vertical-channel configurations with spatially periodic wall temperatures Dritselis et al. (2013); Hossain and Floryan (2015). The present problem is distinct in that the central observable is not an instability threshold or a global heat-transfer enhancement, but a second-order redistribution of the mean wall heat flux caused by deliberate breaking of the reflection symmetry between the two walls.

The word *pumping* requires a qualification, because it is used in the literature for a different device. Thermal-wave pumping produces a net mean flow by means of a temperature wave travelling along the boundary Hossain and Floryan (2023); the present rectified quantity is not a propulsive flux but the difference between the two wall heat fluxes, i.e. a redistribution of heat across the channel at strictly fixed bulk flow rate. The mechanisms are also unrelated: there the asymmetry is imposed by a propagating phase, here it is imposed by the parity of a standing quadratic interaction between a symmetric and an antisymmetric thermal mode.

Weakly nonlinear expansions are a natural tool for identifying such rectified responses. In hydrodynamic stability theory, nonlinear interactions between Fourier modes and the associated mean-flow corrections form a standard framework Stuart (1960); symmetry and mode selection are likewise central to the broader theory of pattern-forming systems Cross and Hohenberg (1993). Here, however, the reference state is not studied as an instability threshold. The weakly nonlinear expansion is used to expose an exact symmetry selection rule embedded in the steady forced transport problem.

For identical upper and lower wall modulations, $\varepsilon_1 = \varepsilon_2$, the leading second-order wall-flux redistribution is symmetry-forbidden. The corresponding nonlinear forcing is even in the transverse coordinate and cannot generate a persistent difference between the two inward wall heat fluxes. The symmetric configuration therefore supplies a precise baseline against which the effect of structural asymmetry can be isolated.

The present study asks what happens when $\varepsilon_1 \neq \varepsilon_2$. We answer this question at two levels. First, reflection symmetry and uniqueness produce an exact selection rule: the mixed symmetric–antisymmetric interaction is odd in the transverse coordinate, and therefore its second-order wall-flux corrections are equal in magnitude and opposite in sign. Second, the amplitude and sign of this redistribution are determined by the coupled

thermal and hydrodynamic response and hence remain parameter dependent. This distinction is central: wall-flux antisymmetry is exact under the stated assumptions, whereas nonzero pumping, its $k \to 0$ scaling, and the location of its zero crossing are dynamical results requiring quantitative calculation.

The contributions of the paper are therefore threefold.

1. An **exact symmetry-selection theorem** (Theorem 1): the mixed symmetric–antisymmetric second-order forcing is odd, hence $Nu_{2,0}(+1) = -Nu_{2,0}(-1)$ for every admissible (Re, Pr, Gr, k), and pure symmetric or pure antisymmetric heating produce no directional redistribution at this order.

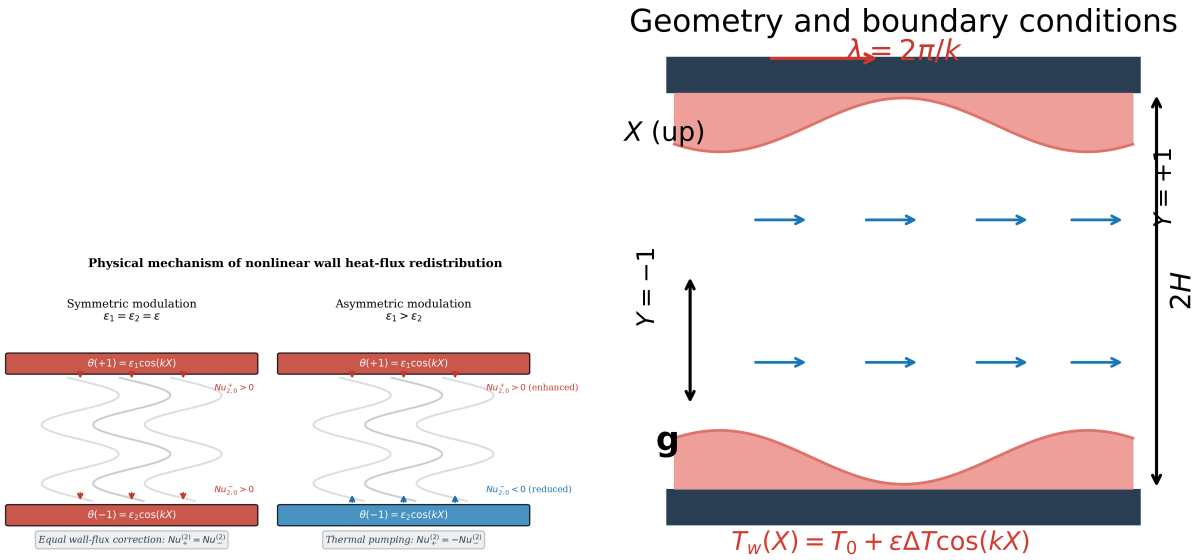
2. An **exact two-coefficient phase law** (Proposition 2): for phase-shifted wall modulation the rectified wall-flux response is governed by the real and imaginary parts of the product $\varepsilon_a \varepsilon_s^*$, each multiplying an independent pumping coefficient. For equal wall amplitudes the dependence on the phase is exactly $\sin\phi$, with no higher harmonic, and the quadrature coefficient $\Pi_T^{\perp}$ has the *opposite sign* to the published in-phase coefficient Π_T.

3. A **dynamical mapping of the reversal**, validated by fully nonlinear DNS: the parity cancellation itself is reproduced in DNS to 3.1×10^{-18} in the wall-flux difference, which is 2.7×10^{-11} of the flux measured; the reversal point Re_c at fixed Pe is independent of Gr to 1.2×10^{-10} perturbatively and keeps its sign across a Grashof pair in DNS; the locus is mapped as a function of k and confirmed on both sides of four of its crossings; and a term-wise phase analysis identifies which nonlinear transport contribution loses the balance as Re increases.

What is deliberately *not* claimed is universality: the results are two-dimensional, laminar, and restricted to the parameter domain where the second-order expansion is quantitatively controlled.

Relation to the companion study. This paper continues a line of work on the same canonical configuration. The companion study treats the *symmetric* wall modulation: it develops the exact integral framework for the first-order complex thermal amplitude, including the non-monotonic k-dependence of the mode-coupling coefficient. The present study changes the object of interest: it is the asymmetric configuration, the exact parity selection rule that follows from it, and the dynamical consequences of that rule. The contrast is not one of parameters but of which quantity is observable at all. Section 3 argues that the symmetric and antisymmetric cases pin the two rectified flux corrections to equality, and then, through the periodic energy balance, to zero — the endpoint representation of Supplementary Sec. S5.7 is what turns that balance into a statement about the two wall fluxes — so that in the symmetric limit the response measured here vanishes by construction and neither a reversal of its direction nor a phase law for it can be defined. Only the

shared canonical geometry and the standard nondimensional Navier–Stokes–Boussinesq statement appear again; no derivation, table or figure of the companion study is reproduced here, and none of the results quoted below is taken from it. That manuscript has not yet appeared in print or on a preprint server, so it carries no citable identifier; it is therefore described in the text rather than cited in the reference list, and is supplied to the editor on request. Fig. 1 shows the configuration and the two parity classes of wall modulation it makes accessible, and Fig. S10 traces the chain from wall symmetry to the admissible second-order response.



(a) Mechanism: symmetric versus unequal wall amplitudes.

(b) Geometry, base flow and nondimensionalization.

Figure 1: Physical schematic of the wall heat-flux redistribution mechanism and the configuration on which it acts. The symmetric limit suppresses the antisymmetric wall-flux correction, whereas unequal wall-modulation amplitudes activate the mixed symmetric–antisymmetric interaction responsible for the second-order redistribution. The vertical channel has walls at $Y = \pm 1$, half-width H, base Poiseuille flow $U_0(Y) = \frac{3}{2}(1 - Y^2)$, gravity in the vertical direction, and periodically modulated wall temperatures with amplitudes ε_1 and ε_2.

2 Formulation and Base State

A laminar, incompressible Newtonian fluid flows steadily through a vertical parallel-plate channel with walls at $Y = \pm 1$.[1] The dimensional half-width is H, and the reference velocity U_0 is the bulk velocity used for nondimensionalization. The X axis is vertical and gravity acts in the negative X direction. After removal of the hydrostatic pressure

[1] The Boussinesq formulation, the plane-Poiseuille base state, the nondimensionalization and the first-order thermal problem are reproduced here for completeness.

contribution, the dimensionless Boussinesq system is

$$\partial_X U + \partial_Y V = 0, \tag{1}$$

$$U\partial_X U + V\partial_Y U = -\partial_X P + \frac{1}{Re}\nabla^2 U + \frac{Gr}{Re^2}\theta, \tag{2}$$

$$U\partial_X V + V\partial_Y V = -\partial_Y P + \frac{1}{Re}\nabla^2 V, \tag{3}$$

$$U\partial_X \theta + V\partial_Y \theta = \frac{1}{RePr}\nabla^2 \theta, \tag{4}$$

where $Re = U_0 H/\nu$, $Pr = \nu/\alpha$, $Pe = RePr$, and $Gr = g\beta\Delta T H^3/\nu^2$. The applicability of the Boussinesq approximation is assumed in the usual small-density-variation regime Gray and Giorgini (1976).

The unperturbed hydrodynamic state is the fully developed Poiseuille flow

$$U_0(Y) = \frac{3}{2}(1 - Y^2), \qquad V_0 = 0, \tag{5}$$

whose cross-sectional mean is unity. The zero-order thermal state is taken as the reference state, so that the imposed wall modulation is

$$\theta(X, +1) = \varepsilon_1 \cos(kX), \tag{6}$$

$$\theta(X, -1) = \varepsilon_2 \cos(kX). \tag{7}$$

No-slip conditions apply at both walls and the solution is periodic in X with period $2\pi/k$.

The wall amplitudes are decomposed as

$$\varepsilon_s = \frac{\varepsilon_1 + \varepsilon_2}{2}, \qquad \varepsilon_a = \frac{\varepsilon_1 - \varepsilon_2}{2}, \tag{8}$$

so that $\varepsilon_1 = \varepsilon_s + \varepsilon_a$ and $\varepsilon_2 = \varepsilon_s - \varepsilon_a$.

For the first-order fields we use

$$\theta_1^{(j)}(X, Y) = \Re\{\Theta^{(j)}(Y) e^{-ikX}\}, \tag{9}$$

$$V_1^{(j)}(X, Y) = \Re\{\widehat{V}^{(j)}(Y) e^{-ikX}\}, \tag{10}$$

with $j \in \{s, a\}$ and $\Theta^{(j)} = \theta_c^{(j)} + i\theta_s^{(j)}$. A streamfunction may be introduced according to

$$U_1^{(j)} = \partial_Y \psi_1^{(j)}, \qquad V_1^{(j)} = -\partial_X \psi_1^{(j)}, \tag{11}$$

so incompressibility is identically satisfied. With the e^{-ikX} convention, continuity gives

$$\boxed{\widehat{U}^{(j)} = -\frac{i}{k}(\widehat{V}^{(j)})'.} \tag{12}$$

The weakly nonlinear expansion is organized as

$$\theta = \varepsilon_s\theta_1^{(s)} + \varepsilon_a\theta_1^{(a)} + \varepsilon_s^2\theta_{ss,2} + \varepsilon_a^2\theta_{aa,2} + \varepsilon_a\varepsilon_s\theta_{as,2} + O(\varepsilon^3), \tag{13}$$

$$(U, V) = (U_0, 0) + \varepsilon_s(U_1^{(s)}, V_1^{(s)}) + \varepsilon_a(U_1^{(a)}, V_1^{(a)}) + O(\varepsilon^2). \tag{14}$$

2.1 First-order thermal problems

The first-order thermal amplitudes satisfy

$$\mathcal{L}_T\Theta^{(j)} \equiv (D^2 - k^2)\Theta^{(j)} + ikPeU_0(Y)\Theta^{(j)} = 0, \qquad D \equiv \frac{d}{dY}, \tag{15}$$

with

$$\Theta^{(s)}(-1) = \Theta^{(s)}(+1) = 1, \tag{16}$$

$$\Theta^{(a)}(-1) = -1, \qquad \Theta^{(a)}(+1) = 1. \tag{17}$$

Thus the thermal modes depend on the thermal control combination Pe together with k. For completeness we note that problem (15) with symmetric wall data is the first-order thermal problem analysed in the companion integral-identity study of this series; it is reproduced here because the present argument needs both parities simultaneously, and none of the results quoted below is taken from that study.

2.2 First-order hydrodynamic response

Let $\mathcal{L} = D^2 - k^2$. Taking the curl of the linearized momentum equations and eliminating pressure gives

$$\mathcal{L}^2\widehat{V}^{(j)} + ikRe\left[U_0\mathcal{L}\widehat{V}^{(j)} - U_0''\widehat{V}^{(j)}\right] + i\frac{kGr}{Re}\left(\Theta^{(j)}\right)' = 0. \tag{18}$$

with

$$\widehat{V}^{(j)}(\pm 1) = 0, \qquad (\widehat{V}^{(j)})'(\pm 1) = 0. \tag{19}$$

The corresponding linear vorticity relation is

$$U_0\partial_X\omega_1 - V_1U_0'' = \frac{1}{Re}\nabla^2\omega_1 - \frac{Gr}{Re^2}\partial_Y\theta_1. \tag{20}$$

Taking the streamwise derivative of the transverse momentum equation minus the transverse derivative of the streamwise momentum equation, and eliminating the pressure, is what converts this relation into the fourth-order problem Eq. (18); the elimination is written out in Sec. S5.1 of the supplementary material. Because the thermal fields are

independent of Gr and the hydrodynamic operator is linear, at fixed (k, Re, Pr),

$$\widehat{V}^{(j)} = Gr\,\widetilde{V}^{(j)}, \qquad \widehat{U}^{(j)} = Gr\,\widetilde{U}^{(j)}. \tag{21}$$

3 Symmetry-Selected Nonlinear Thermal Pumping

3.1 Reflection parity of the first-order thermal modes

Let $\mathcal{R}[f](Y) = f(-Y)$. Since U_0 is even, $\mathcal{R}$ commutes with the thermal operator. Uniqueness therefore gives

$$\Theta^{(s)}(-Y) = \Theta^{(s)}(Y), \qquad \Theta^{(a)}(-Y) = -\Theta^{(a)}(Y). \tag{22}$$

Hence $\Theta^{(s)}$ is even and $(\Theta^{(s)})'$ odd, while $\Theta^{(a)}$ is odd and $(\Theta^{(a)})'$ even. The commutation of $\mathcal{R}$ with both first-order operators, which is what makes the parity assignment unique rather than accidental, is spelled out in Sec. S5.2 of the supplementary material.

3.2 Reflection parity of the first-order hydrodynamic modes

Since U_0 and U_0'' are even, the hydrodynamic operator is also reflection invariant. The forcing in Eq. (18) is odd for the symmetric thermal mode and even for the antisymmetric one. Uniqueness of the homogeneous-boundary hydrodynamic BVP gives

$$\widehat{V}^{(s)}(-Y) = -\widehat{V}^{(s)}(Y), \qquad \widehat{V}^{(a)}(-Y) = \widehat{V}^{(a)}(Y), \tag{23}$$

and Eq. (12) gives

$$\widehat{U}^{(s)}(-Y) = \widehat{U}^{(s)}(Y), \qquad \widehat{U}^{(a)}(-Y) = -\widehat{U}^{(a)}(Y). \tag{24}$$

3.3 Explicit quadratic cross-interaction

The streamwise-averaged second-order energy equation is

$$\theta_{2,0}'' = Pe\left[\varepsilon_a^2\mathcal{E}_{aa} + \varepsilon_s^2\mathcal{E}_{ss} + \varepsilon_a\varepsilon_s\mathcal{E}_{as}\right], \qquad \theta_{2,0}(\pm 1) = 0, \tag{25}$$

where

$$\mathcal{E}_{jj}(Y) = \left\langle U_1^{(j)}\partial_X\theta_1^{(j)} + V_1^{(j)}\partial_Y\theta_1^{(j)}\right\rangle_X, \qquad j \in \{s, a\}, \tag{26}$$

$$\mathcal{E}_{as}(Y) = \left\langle U_1^{(a)}\partial_X\theta_1^{(s)} + U_1^{(s)}\partial_X\theta_1^{(a)} + V_1^{(a)}\partial_Y\theta_1^{(s)} + V_1^{(s)}\partial_Y\theta_1^{(a)}\right\rangle_X. \tag{27}$$

The complex-amplitude form is

$$\mathcal{E}_{as}(Y) = \frac{1}{2}\Re\Big[\widehat{U}^{(a)}\overline{-ik\Theta^{(s)}} + \widehat{U}^{(s)}\overline{-ik\Theta^{(a)}} + \widehat{V}^{(a)}\overline{(\Theta^{(s)})'} + \widehat{V}^{(s)}\overline{(\Theta^{(a)})'}\Big]. \tag{28}$$

Each of the four terms is the product of an even and an odd profile, so their sum is odd; the term-by-term parity bookkeeping is tabulated in Sec. S5.3 of the supplementary material.

3.4 Second-order mean momentum and streaming current

The streamwise-averaged second-order momentum equation may be written as

$$\frac{1}{Re}U_{2,0}'' + G_2 = \mathcal{N}(Y) - \frac{Gr}{Re^2}\theta_{2,0}(Y), \tag{29}$$

where

$$\mathcal{N}(Y) = \langle U_1\partial_X U_1 + V_1\partial_Y U_1\rangle_X . \tag{30}$$

For fixed bulk flow,

$$U_{2,0}(\pm 1) = 0, \qquad \int_{-1}^{1} U_{2,0}(Y)\,dY = 0, \tag{31}$$

which determines the pressure-gradient correction G_2. The streaming calculation is therefore a separate second-order problem; the wall-flux symmetry theorem itself follows already from the first-order thermal and transverse-velocity parities. The mean momentum balance that leads to the constraint above, and the solvability condition that fixes G_2, are derived in Sec. S5.4 of the supplementary material.

The parity table is

	symmetric (s)	antisymmetric (a)
Θ	even	odd
Θ'	odd	even
$\widehat{V}$	odd	even
$\widehat{U}$	even	odd

Every term in Eq. (28) is therefore odd, so

$$\boxed{\mathcal{E}_{as}(-Y) = -\mathcal{E}_{as}(Y)}. \tag{32}$$

Also, $U_1\partial_X\theta_1 + V_1\partial_Y\theta_1 = \partial_X(U_1\theta_1) + \partial_Y(V_1\theta_1)$. Periodic averaging and $V_1(\pm 1) = 0$ yield

$$\int_{-1}^{1} \mathcal{E}_{as}(Y)\,dY = 0. \tag{33}$$

3.5 Solvability and wall-flux identities

For the mixed contribution,

$$\theta''_{as,2} = Pe\,\mathcal{E}_{as}, \qquad \theta_{as,2}(\pm 1) = 0. \tag{34}$$

Because the forcing is odd, uniqueness gives

$$\theta_{as,2}(-Y) = -\theta_{as,2}(Y), \qquad \theta'_{as,2}(-Y) = \theta'_{as,2}(Y). \tag{35}$$

With inward-normal wall fluxes

$$Nu_{2,0}(+1) = -\theta'_{as,2}(+1), \qquad Nu_{2,0}(-1) = +\theta'_{as,2}(-1), \tag{36}$$

we obtain

$$\boxed{Nu_{2,0}(+1) = -Nu_{2,0}(-1)}. \tag{37}$$

This is the exact symmetry theorem. It constrains the two-wall relation but does not imply a nonzero coefficient at every parameter value.

For the symmetry-preserving pure symmetric and pure antisymmetric cases, the second-order forcing is even, the mean temperature correction is even, and the two inward flux corrections are equal. The periodic energy balance gives zero net second-order heat input, so the equal corrections must vanish individually.

Theorem 1 (Nonlinear thermal pumping symmetry law)**.** *Assume a reflection-symmetric laminar base state, unique first-order thermal and hydrodynamic BVP solutions, spatially periodic harmonic wall forcing, and validity of the second-order perturbation expansion. Then the mixed symmetric–antisymmetric second-order contribution satisfies*

$$Nu_{2,0}(+1) = -Nu_{2,0}(-1) \tag{38}$$

for every admissible (Re, Pr, Gr, k) *for which the stated perturbative expansion and the associated unique boundary-value problems are valid.*

Proof. The reflection parities of the first-order thermal and velocity modes are given by Eqs. (22)–(24). They make every term of the mixed quadratic forcing odd, hence $\mathcal{E}_{as}$ is odd. The unique Dirichlet solution of Eq. (34) is therefore odd and its derivative even. Applying the opposite inward normals at $Y = \pm 1$ gives Eq. (37). Sec. S5.5 of the supplementary material repeats the argument in operator form, with the reflection operator acting on each boundary-value problem, for completeness. □

4 Exact Pumping Identities and Reynolds-Number Dependence

4.1 Definition

The normalized transverse wall-flux redistribution is defined by

$$\Pi_T(k, Pe, Gr; Re, Pr) = \frac{Nu_{2,0}(+1) - Nu_{2,0}(-1)}{2\varepsilon_a\varepsilon_s} = \frac{Nu_{2,0}(+1)}{\varepsilon_a\varepsilon_s}. \tag{39}$$

With the present sign convention, $\Pi_T > 0$ corresponds to enhanced inward flux at the upper wall relative to the lower wall, while $\Pi_T < 0$ corresponds to the reverse redistribution.

4.2 Exact Green-function identity

For $\theta'' = f(Y)$ with homogeneous Dirichlet conditions,

$$\theta'(1) = \frac{1}{2}\int_{-1}^{1}(1+Y)f(Y)\,dY, \qquad \theta'(-1) = -\frac{1}{2}\int_{-1}^{1}(1-Y)f(Y)\,dY. \tag{40}$$

For the odd forcing $f = Pe\mathcal{E}_{as}$,

$$\boxed{\Pi_T = -\frac{Pe}{2}\int_{-1}^{1} Y\,\mathcal{E}_{as}(Y)\,dY.} \tag{41}$$

This identity is independent of the numerical method used for the mean second-order problem and is therefore an especially useful verification target. Sec. S5.7 of the supplementary material derives the two endpoint representations from the Dirichlet Green function and shows how they reduce, for an odd forcing, to the quadrature form quoted above.

Proposition 1 (Linearity in Grashof number)**.** *At fixed* (k, Re, Pr)*,*

$$\boxed{\Pi_T(k, Pe, Gr; Re, Pr) = GrA(k, Re, Pr).} \tag{42}$$

Proof. The thermal amplitudes are independent of Gr, whereas the hydrodynamic BVP is linear and its forcing is proportional to $Gr\Theta'$. Hence both $\widehat{V}$ and $\widehat{U}$ are proportional to Gr, so Eq. (28) gives $\mathcal{E}_{as} = Gr\widetilde{\mathcal{E}}_{as}$. Equation (41) then gives the asserted linearity. Sec. S5.6 of the supplementary material gives the same statement for the quadrature coefficient. □

Corollary 1 (Grashof-independence of the reversal point)**.** *Because* $\Pi_T = GrA(k, Re, Pr)$ *with* $Gr > 0$*, the set of* (k, Pe, Re, Pr) *at which* Π_T *vanishes coincides exactly with the set at which* A *vanishes. The location of a pumping reversal is therefore independent*

of Gr: varying the buoyancy amplitude rescales the response without moving its zero or changing its sign. The same argument applies verbatim to the quadrature coefficient $\Pi_T^{\perp}$ *of Proposition 2, since it is also proportional to Gr at fixed* (k, Re, Pr).

Proof. Linearity of Proposition 1 gives $\Pi_T/Gr = A$ with A independent of Gr; since $Gr > 0$, $\Pi_T = 0 \iff A = 0$, and $\operatorname{sgn}\Pi_T = \operatorname{sgn} A$ for every Gr. The quadrature coefficient obeys the identical scaling because the hydrodynamic modes that enter its kernel are the same Gr-linear solutions. □

This corollary is a structural prediction rather than an asymptotic one, and it is directly testable. At $k = 0.8$ and $Pe = 7$ the reversal Reynolds number was located by Brent iteration on the authoritative perturbative solver for four Grashof numbers:

Gr	25	50	100	200
Re_c	30.838496520	30.838496520	30.838496520	30.838496520

(43)

the four values agreeing to the nine displayed digits, with an absolute spread of 1.2×10^{-10}. The corresponding normalized responses $A = \Pi_T/Gr$ are invariant across the same sweep to a worst-case relative spread of 7.3×10^{-11} at $Re = 25, 30, 35$ and to 1.0×10^{-13} at the reference $Re = 10$ (Table S3), i.e. to the convergence level of the boundary-value solver rather than to any modelling approximation.

4.3 Parameter dependence and Reynolds-number dependence

The normalized response $A = \Pi_T/Gr$ is, in general, a function of (k, Re, Pr). Although the thermal operator contains Re and Pr through the product $Pe = RePr$, the hydrodynamic operator retains explicit dependence on Re. Consequently there is no exact reduction to $A(k, Pe)$ in the general problem.

At fixed $Re = 10$, however, one may use Pe as the thermal control parameter by setting $Pr = Pe/Re$. A direct fixed-Pe test at $k = 0.8$ and $Gr = 100$ confirms that the resulting map is not universal with respect to Re. For $Pe = 7$, for example,

Re	5	10	20	35
$A = \Pi_T/Gr$	-1.5951×10^{-3}	-4.7485×10^{-4}	-6.4279×10^{-5}	6.7452×10^{-6}

(44)

so the Reynolds number remains an active hydrodynamic control parameter, and Table S1 gives the corresponding fixed-Pe map.

4.4 Long-wavelength limit

For $k \to 0$,

$$\Theta^{(s)}(Y) = 1 + ika_s(Y) + O(k^2), \qquad a_s'' = -PeU_0, \qquad a_s(\pm 1) = 0, \tag{45}$$

$$\Theta^{(a)}(Y) = Y + ika_a(Y) + O(k^2), \qquad a_a'' = -PeU_0 Y, \qquad a_a(\pm 1) = 0. \tag{46}$$

Thus $(\Theta^{(s)})' = O(k)$ whereas $(\Theta^{(a)})' = 1 + O(k)$. Equation (18) then gives

$$\widehat{V}^{(a)} = O(k), \qquad \widehat{U}^{(a)} = O(1), \qquad \widehat{V}^{(s)} = O(k^2), \qquad \widehat{U}^{(s)} = O(k), \tag{47}$$

so every cross-forcing contribution is $O(k^2)$ and

$$\boxed{A(k, Re, Pr) = A_2(Re, Pr)k^2 + o(k^2), \qquad k \to 0.} \tag{48}$$

The numerical sequence at $(Re, Pr, Gr) = (10, 0.7, 100)$ gives a log–log exponent $p = 1.9955$ with $R^2 = 1.0000$ over $0.002 \le k \le 0.03$, while Π_T/k^2 remains close to -2.2. The observed exponent is therefore consistent with the analytic k^2 law; Table S2 gives the fit over the tested interval.

For large k, the temperature perturbations become increasingly localized near the two walls, with a generic geometric penetration scale proportional to k^{-1}. We use this only as a qualitative explanation for the decay of cross-wall coupling and do not infer a universal large-k exponent. The indicator $\Lambda = (kPe)^{-1/2}$ is introduced only as a scaling measure for the competition between streamwise advection and transverse diffusion.

5 Phase-Shifted Forcing and the Two-Coefficient Law

5.1 Complex forcing amplitudes

Let the two wall modulations differ both in amplitude and in streamwise phase,

$$\theta(X, +1) = \varepsilon_1 \cos(kX), \qquad \theta(X, -1) = \varepsilon_2 \cos(kX + \phi), \tag{49}$$

with $\varepsilon_1, \varepsilon_2 \ge 0$ and $\phi \in [0, 2\pi)$. Writing every first-order field as $\Re\big[\widehat{(\cdot)}\, e^{-ikX}\big]$, the wall data are $\widehat{\theta}_1(+1) = \varepsilon_1$ and $\widehat{\theta}_1(-1) = \varepsilon_2 e^{-i\phi}$, and the symmetric/antisymmetric split becomes

$$A_s = \tfrac{1}{2}\big(\varepsilon_1 + \varepsilon_2 e^{-i\phi}\big), \qquad A_a = \tfrac{1}{2}\big(\varepsilon_1 - \varepsilon_2 e^{-i\phi}\big). \tag{50}$$

Because the first-order thermal and hydrodynamic problems are linear and invariant under streamwise translation, the response to a complex amplitude is the amplitude times the

unit-amplitude response. Only the two real scalars

$$c = \Re\big(A_a A_s^*\big), \qquad d = \mathrm{Im}\big(A_a A_s^*\big) \tag{51}$$

survive the streamwise averaging of a mixed quadratic product, so the phase dependence of the rectified response is completely carried by (c, d).

5.2 Two independent mixed kernels

The streamwise-averaged mixed forcing separates exactly into two fixed profiles,

$$\mathcal{E}_{as}(Y \mid A_s, A_a) = c\,\mathcal{K}_c(Y) + d\,\mathcal{K}_q(Y), \tag{52}$$

each built from the symmetric and antisymmetric first-order thermal and hydrodynamic modes. Their construction, and the proof that each profile is odd in Y so that the parity theorem applies to them separately, are given in Sec. S6 of the supplementary material; the in-phase kernel $\mathcal{K}_c$ alone reproduces the amplitude-asymmetric configuration, and the quadrature kernel $\mathcal{K}_q$ is the additional degree of freedom that phase-shifted forcing excites. Applying the Green functional of Eq. (41) to the two profiles defines two independent pumping coefficients,

$$\Pi_T = -\frac{Pe}{2}\int_{-1}^{1} Y\,\mathcal{K}_c(Y)\,dY, \qquad \Pi_T^{\perp} = -\frac{Pe}{2}\int_{-1}^{1} Y\,\mathcal{K}_q(Y)\,dY. \tag{53}$$

Proposition 2 (Exact two-coefficient phase law)**.** *Under the assumptions of Theorem 1, the second-order mean wall-flux redistribution generated by the forcing* (49) *satisfies, exactly at* $O(\varepsilon^2)$*,*

$$\boxed{\begin{aligned} &Nu_{2,0}(+1) = c\,\Pi_T(k, Pe, Gr; Re, Pr) + d\,\Pi_T^{\perp}(k, Pe, Gr; Re, Pr),\\ &Nu_{2,0}(-1) = -Nu_{2,0}(+1). \end{aligned}} \tag{54}$$

Both coefficients are linear in Gr *at fixed* (k, Re, Pr)*, and neither admits a higher harmonic in* ϕ*.*

Proof. Eq. (52) expresses the mixed forcing as a linear combination of two fixed profiles with ϕ-independent coefficients c, d; the mean thermal problem and the wall-flux functionals are linear, so the two coefficients are pure numbers depending on (k, Pe, Gr, Re, Pr) only. Odd parity of each kernel gives $Nu_{2,0}(-1) = -Nu_{2,0}(+1)$ as in Theorem 1, and Gr-linearity follows as in Proposition 1 because both kernels are built from the same Gr-linear hydrodynamic modes. Since c and d are, respectively, the real and imaginary parts of a single bilinear product of first-order amplitudes, no other ϕ-dependence can appear at this order. □

Corollary 2 (Pure sinusoidal phase dependence)**.** *For equal wall amplitudes* $\varepsilon_1 = \varepsilon_2 = \varepsilon$*,*

$$c = 0, \qquad d = \tfrac{\varepsilon^2}{2} \sin\phi, \qquad \textit{hence} \qquad Nu_{2,0}(+1 \,|\, \phi) = Nu_{2,0}(+1 \,|\, \tfrac{\pi}{2}) \, \sin\phi. \tag{55}$$

The pumping vanishes at $\phi = 0$ *(purely symmetric) and at* $\phi = \pi$ *(purely antisymmetric), is maximal in magnitude at* $\phi = \pi/2$*, and is odd under* $\phi \to -\phi$*, which is the phase analogue of the amplitude interchange reversal. The proportionality constant is* $\Pi_T^{\perp}$*, not the in-phase coefficient* Π_T*.*

Proof. With $\varepsilon_1 = \varepsilon_2 = \varepsilon$, Eq. (50) gives $A_s = \varepsilon \cos(\phi/2) e^{-i\phi/2}$ and $A_a = i\varepsilon \sin(\phi/2) e^{-i\phi/2}$, whence $A_a A_s^* = i(\varepsilon^2/2) \sin\phi$ is purely imaginary. □

5.3 Numerical values and internal validation

At the reference configuration $(k, Pe, Re, Pr, Gr) = (0.8, 7, 10, 0.7, 100)$ the two coefficients are

$$\Pi_T = -4.74850846 \times 10^{-2}, \qquad \Pi_T^{\perp} = +8.89496095 \times 10^{-2}, \qquad \Pi_T^{\perp}/\Pi_T = -1.8732, \tag{56}$$

so the quadrature channel not only differs from the in-phase one, it drives the redistribution in the *opposite* direction and with 1.87 times the magnitude at matched bilinear amplitude. The in-phase value reproduces the authoritative single-case calculation of Section 5 to a relative discrepancy of 4.3×10^{-13}, which validates the kernel decomposition (52) against the published solver.

The law (54) was checked by reconstructing the mixed forcing profile $c\mathcal{K}_c + d\mathcal{K}_q$ and solving the mean thermal problem for twelve randomised triples $(\varepsilon_1, \varepsilon_2, \phi)$; the maximum relative deviation between the algebraic prediction and the direct reconstruction is 5.0×10^{-12}. The sinusoidal form (55) was tested independently of the algebra: the mixed forcing was re-assembled and the mean thermal boundary-value problem re-solved at each of 25 phases spanning $\phi \in [0, \pi]$, and the normalized wall-flux redistribution then lies on $\sin\phi$ to within 2.4×10^{-13}, the in-phase invariant $\Re(A_a A_s^*)$ vanishing to 5.6×10^{-17}. The wall-flux antisymmetry holds for the in-phase and quadrature channels to 6.9×10^{-18} and 1.4×10^{-17} respectively. Both coefficients are linear in Gr: over $Gr = 25$–400 the normalized responses Π_T/Gr and $\Pi_T^{\perp}/Gr$ vary by 1.0×10^{-13} and 3.7×10^{-13} relative respectively, confirming that Corollary 1 covers the new coefficient as well; Sec. 7.11 repeats the scaling in DNS, where the measured Grashof ratio of $q_+ - q_-$ stays within 3.7×10^{-4} of the exact value.

Two structural differences between the channels are worth recording. First, $\Pi_T^{\perp} > 0$ for every $Re \in [5, 50]$ examined at $k = 0.8$ and $Pe = 7$, decreasing monotonically from 1.86×10^{-1} to 8.40×10^{-3}: the quadrature branch shows no reversal in this range, whereas the in-phase branch reverses at $Re_c = 30.838$. The two reversal surfaces in (k, Re) space

are therefore distinct. Second, the ratio $\Pi_T^{\perp}/\Pi_T$ is not constant: it varies from -1.17 at $(k, Re) = (0.4, 5)$ to -36.3 at $(1.6, 10)$, attains $+11.0$ at $(0.8, 40)$ and changes sign across the parameter domain, so $\Pi_T^{\perp}$ cannot be reduced to Π_T by any rescaling.

Figure 2 shows the exact phase selection and Figure 3 the two reversal branches. The prediction (55) is a second-order statement and is therefore directly testable in fully nonlinear DNS. With $\varepsilon = 0.03$ and $\phi = \pi/2$ the theorem gives $Nu_{2,0}(+1) = (\varepsilon^2/2)\Pi_T^{\perp} = +4.003 \times 10^{-5}$, whereas the amplitude-asymmetric DNS configuration already validated in Section 7 ($\varepsilon_s = 0.03$, $\varepsilon_a = 0.005$, $\phi = 0$) gives $Nu_{2,0}(+1) = \varepsilon_s \varepsilon_a \Pi_T = -7.123 \times 10^{-6}$. The phase-shifted configuration is thus predicted to pump in the *opposite* direction with 5.6 times the magnitude at the same (k, Pe, Re, Pr, Gr) and the same nominal modulation amplitude. This is an explicit consequence of the theorem, and it has been tested: the DNS runs of Section 7.12 measure $Nu_{2,0}(+1) = +4.0580 \times 10^{-5}$ at $\phi = \pi/2$ and -4.0580×10^{-5} at $\phi = -\pi/2$, 1.38% from the predicted magnitude and antisymmetric to 9.9×10^{-7} of it.

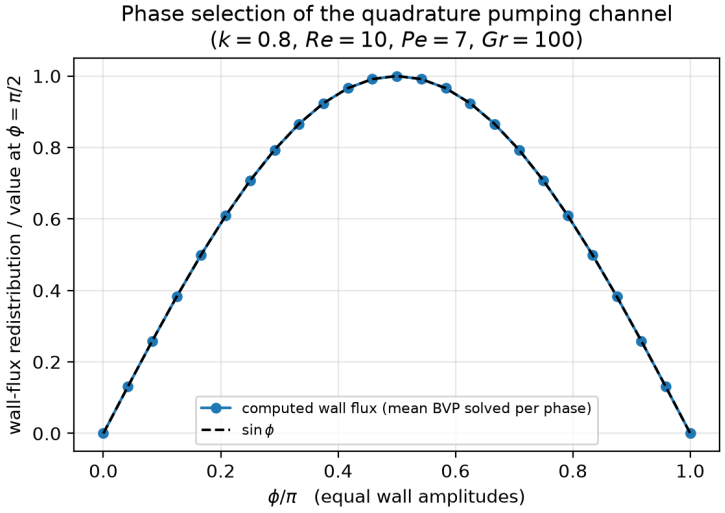


Figure 2: Exact phase selection for equal wall amplitudes at $(k, Pe, Re, Pr, Gr) = (0.8, 7, 10, 0.7, 100)$. Each marker is an independent calculation: the mixed forcing is re-assembled for that phase and the second-order mean thermal problem is re-solved, so the plot is not the analytic expression against itself. The computed normalized response lies on $\sin\phi$ (dashed) to within 2.4×10^{-13}; the response vanishes at the purely symmetric ($\phi = 0$) and purely antisymmetric ($\phi = \pi$) phase relations.

6 Numerical Methods and Verification

Two independent calculations carry the numerical argument. All first-order boundary-value problems are solved by adaptive collocation and checked against a shooting integration of the same equations; the finite-amplitude response is computed by a separate two-dimensional direct numerical simulation of the full Boussinesq system, which takes no

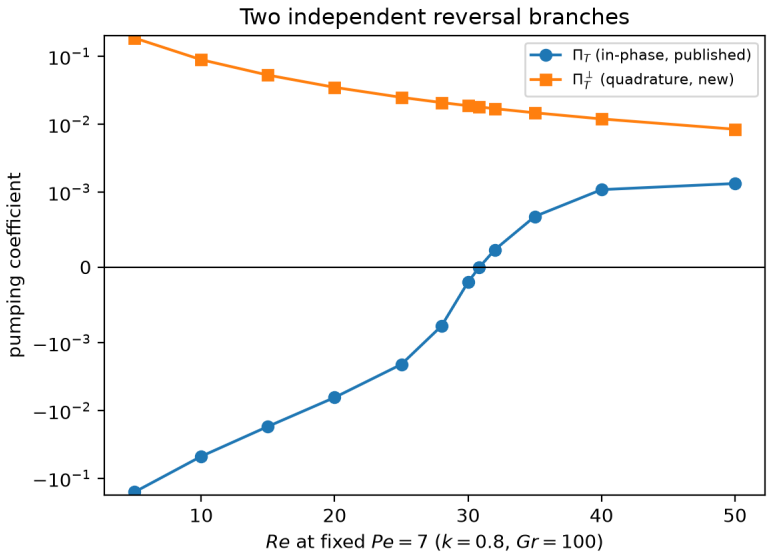


Figure 3: The two independent pumping coefficients versus Reynolds number at fixed $Pe = 7$, $k = 0.8$ and $Gr = 100$. The in-phase coefficient Π_T reverses at $Re_c = 30.838$, while the quadrature coefficient $\Pi_T^{\perp}$ remains positive throughout the scanned interval and decays monotonically.

modal field as input. This section states what each calculation does and with what tolerance; what they produce is reported in Section 7, and the mesh, time-step and amplitude sequences behind the quoted error levels are recorded in Sec. S2 of the supplementary material.

6.1 Numerical implementation and independent validation

All first-order boundary-value problems are solved using the adaptive collocation algorithm `solve_bvp` from SciPy Virtanen et al. (2020). The mixed second-order temperature field is obtained from Eq. (34). The numerical audit is structured around independent consequences of the analysis: BVP residuals and boundary conditions, reflection parity, forcing parity and integral identities, wall-flux antisymmetry, the Green-function identity, collocation–shooting agreement, mesh sensitivity, and the fixed-bulk-flow condition for the mean streaming correction. Sec. S5.8 of the supplementary material records the shooting formulation of both boundary-value problems, which is the independent reconstruction behind the collocation–shooting agreement reported below.

At $(k, Re, Pr, Gr) = (2, 10, 0.7, 100)$, the CPU reference calculation gives

$$Nu_{2,0}(+1) = 1.9730398325 \times 10^{-3}, \qquad Nu_{2,0}(-1) = -1.9730398325 \times 10^{-3}, \tag{57}$$

and hence $\Pi_T = 1.9730398325 \times 10^{-3}$. The independent integral representation agrees to within 3.2×10^{-13}, and the quadrature cross-check is $O(10^{-11})$. The maximum parity residual is below 7×10^{-17} and the wall-flux antisymmetry residual below 9×10^{-19}.

Independent collocation–shooting field differences remain below 9×10^{-12}. The fixed-bulk-flow mean streaming correction satisfies its integral constraint to 1.1×10^{-16}.

The reference result is also insensitive to the initial collocation mesh. Calculations with $N_0 = 101, 201, 401, 801$ and a finer reference initialization differ from the reported value only in the last displayed digits. These tests support the use of the adaptive collocation result as the authoritative CPU reference while the shooting calculation supplies an independent field reconstruction. Table 1 collects the diagnostics of that audit.

Table 1: Representative numerical validation diagnostics for the reference case $(k, Re, Pr, Gr) = (2, 10, 0.7, 100)$.

Diagnostic	Maximum reported magnitude
First-order residuals	1.5×10^{-14}
Thermal/velocity parity residuals	6.8×10^{-17}
$\int \mathcal{E}_{as}\, dY$	4.3×10^{-19}
Wall-flux antisymmetry	8.7×10^{-19}
Wall-vs-integral Π_T discrepancy	3.2×10^{-13}
Quadrature cross-check	1.8×10^{-11}
Collocation–shooting difference	8.6×10^{-12}
Zero-bulk-flux residual	1.1×10^{-16}

6.2 Direct numerical simulation: formulation, estimator and independence

The perturbation theory developed above is based on the assumption that the wall-temperature modulation amplitude is sufficiently small for the asymptotic expansion to remain valid through second order. Although the analytical results are internally verified by the boundary-value and shooting formulations, an independent nonlinear calculation is required to determine whether the predicted pumping response persists in the fully coupled finite-amplitude transport problem. We therefore perform a separate two-dimensional direct numerical simulation (DNS) of the nonlinear Boussinesq equations.

The DNS does not use the first-order thermal or hydrodynamic modal solutions as input. Instead, the fully nonlinear temperature and momentum equations are integrated directly to a stationary state under the same periodic wall forcing, with the wall heat-flux difference evaluated from the converged temperature field. The DNS is consequently an independent test of the perturbative mechanism rather than a second implementation of the same boundary-value calculation. Four numbers from that campaign carry the argument of Section 7: the parity cancellation measured at 3.1×10^{-18} in the wall-flux difference, the eight bracketed runs that all return the predicted reversal sign, the Grashof ratio exact to 3.7×10^{-4}, and the quadrature coefficient recovered to 1.38%.

Unless otherwise stated, the reference DNS configuration is

$$(k, Pe, Re, Pr, Gr) = (0.8, 7, 10, 0.7, 100), \tag{58}$$

with

$$\varepsilon_s = 0.03, \qquad \varepsilon_a = 0.005, \tag{59}$$

so that

$$\varepsilon_1 = 0.035, \qquad \varepsilon_2 = 0.025. \tag{60}$$

The nonlinear DNS is performed independently of the perturbative BVP solver. The stationary state is accepted only after the residual of the discretized evolution equations falls below the prescribed convergence threshold and the wall-flux observables become stationary.

The DNS estimator mirrors the perturbative definition (39) and is formed from the cycle-averaged wall-normal wall heat fluxes $q_\pm$ alone. Because $q_+ - q_-$ is the fully nonlinear counterpart of $Nu_{2,0}(+1) - Nu_{2,0}(-1)$, the coefficient recovered from the simulation is

$$\Pi_T^{\mathrm{DNS}} \;=\; \frac{q_+ - q_-}{2\varepsilon_a \varepsilon_s}. \tag{61}$$

For the reference configuration, $q_+ - q_- = -1.40289979 \times 10^{-5}$ and $2\varepsilon_a\varepsilon_s = 3.0 \times 10^{-4}$, giving $\Pi_T^{\mathrm{DNS}} = -4.6763 \times 10^{-2}$, the value quoted in Table 2. No first-order modal field enters the estimator, which is what makes the comparison independent of the perturbative solver.

7 Results and Independent Nonlinear DNS Validation

The evidence is ordered as the claims are. The perturbative scalings come first, because within the model they are exact and they fix what the nonlinear runs are supposed to reproduce. The reversal map follows, because it is the prediction the simulation is asked to bracket. The campaign that tests the whole chain at finite amplitude closes the section, together with the two places where it falsifies its own pre-registered error model.

7.1 Grashof-number scaling

A dedicated sweep at $(k, Re, Pr) = (0.8, 10, 0.7)$ gives a free-intercept fit

$$\Pi_T = (-4.7485 \times 10^{-4})\,Gr - 5.51 \times 10^{-16}, \tag{62}$$

with $R^2 = 1.000000$. The $Gr = 0$ calculation gives zero pumping to numerical precision, confirming Eq. (42); the sweep is plotted in Fig. S1.

7.2 Finite-domain endpoint of the zero-crossing branch

At fixed $Re = 10$ and $Gr = 100$ the normalized response $A = \Pi_T/Gr$ changes sign over the (k, Pe) domain, and the zero set

$$\Pi_T(k^*, Pe) = 0 \tag{63}$$

defines an interior pumping-reversal branch wherever a sign change is present within the admissible interval $0.02 \le k \le 10$. This branch terminates because the interval is finite, not because of a bifurcation, and the endpoint is therefore a property of the computational window.

Two calculations bracket that termination. Just below the endpoint the zero is interior: at $Pe = 10.85$ the response changes sign once, at

$$k^* = 9.338218553141, \qquad |\Pi_T(k^*)| = 1.92 \times 10^{-20}. \tag{64}$$

At the endpoint itself the zero has reached the upper boundary,

$$\boxed{Pe_c = 10.871940554611, \qquad k_c = 10,} \tag{65}$$

where the boundary value $\Pi_T(10, Pe_c) = -8.40 \times 10^{-15}$ is zero to the resolution of the calculation. Just above the endpoint the positive branch is gone: at $Pe = 10.9$ every sampled wavenumber gives a negative response and no sign-change bracket exists, the largest (least negative) value being $\Pi_T(10, 10.9) = -1.4068443 \times 10^{-6}$.

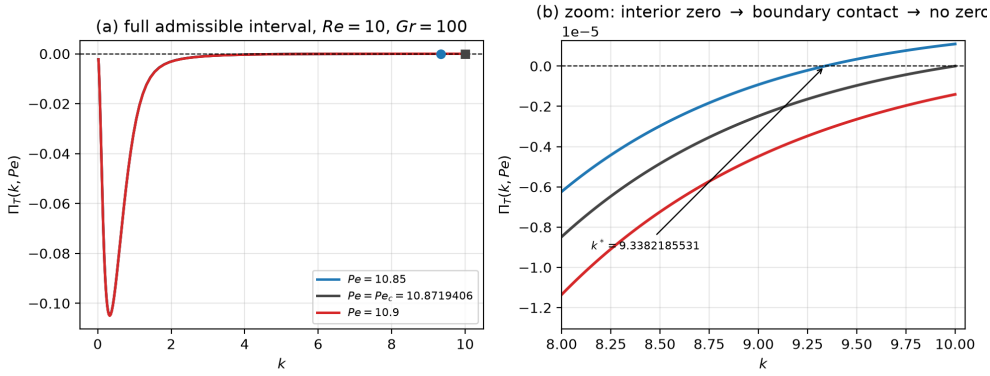


Figure 4: Termination of the interior zero-crossing branch at the finite upper wavenumber boundary ($Re = 10,\ Gr = 100$). (a) Response $\Pi_T(k, Pe)$ over the full admissible interval for the three retained calculations; the curves are visually indistinguishable at this scale, which is itself the point: the change of regime is a near-zero effect confined to $k \gtrsim 8$. (b) High-wavenumber zoom. The interior zero at $k^* = 9.3382185531$ for $Pe = 10.85$ migrates to the boundary $k = 10$ at $Pe = Pe_c$ and disappears for $Pe = 10.9$.

Figure 4 shows the three regimes in one view: interior zero, boundary contact, and complete loss of positive response inside the window. The endpoint is reached geometrically, when the zero set of $\Pi_T(k, Pe)$ first touches $k = k_{\max} = 10$; it is not prescribed as an independent critical parameter. A dense local check at that boundary confirms that the transition is transversal rather than a sampling artefact: with $\delta = Pe - Pe_c$, the boundary value is $\Pi_T(10, Pe_c - \delta) = +5.00619 \times 10^{-8}$ and $+5.00641 \times 10^{-9}$ for $\delta = 10^{-3}$ and 10^{-4}, and $\Pi_T(10, Pe_c + \delta) = -5.00648 \times 10^{-9}$ and -5.00671×10^{-8} for the same two offsets. The magnitudes are nearly antisymmetric about Pe_c, so the boundary value crosses zero with a finite local slope $\partial\Pi_T/\partial Pe \approx -5.01 \times 10^{-5}$ at $(k, Pe) = (10, Pe_c)$; the full five-row ladder is in group A of the supplementary data package.

The endpoint must therefore be read strictly as a *finite-domain dynamical endpoint* of the observed zero-crossing branch for $(Re, Gr) = (10, 100)$ on $0.02 \le k \le 10$ — not a universal critical Péclet number, not an instability threshold. The survey supporting this classification (173 wavenumbers per Pe for five Pe values, 865 first-order BVP evaluations, plus the local ΔPe ladder quoted above) is archived as group A of the supplementary data package, which records the raw grid, the refined roots, the ΔPe ladder and the run log of that survey; the two bracketing calculations above are the ones used in the main text.

7.3 Mean profile structure

The second-order mean temperature correction and mean streaming velocity provide a complementary picture of the redistribution mechanism. For one-sided asymmetric forcing ($\varepsilon_2 = 0$), the mixed mean thermal correction is odd while the corresponding mean velocity correction reflects the accompanying momentum redistribution under fixed bulk flow.

7.4 Convergence of the nonlinear estimator

Four sequences fix the reliability of the nonlinear observable; the sequences themselves are recorded in Sec. S2.1 of the supplementary material. As the asymmetry amplitude decreases at fixed $\varepsilon_s = 0.03$, Π_T^{DNS} converges to -4.6763×10^{-2}, which recovers the second-order perturbative value -4.7485×10^{-2} to 1.52% (Fig. S4). The approach to a finite limit is the nonlinear evidence that Π_T is the leading transport coefficient of the symmetric–antisymmetric interaction rather than an amplitude artefact. Refining the mesh from 48×37 to 96×73 moves the coefficient monotonically by at most 1.10%, and refining the time step from 3.0×10^{-3} to 1.0×10^{-3} by at most 1.75×10^{-6} (Figs. S5 and S6), so the wall-flux difference is neither under-resolved in the transverse boundary layers nor controlled by the temporal discretisation. At the reference resolution the final evolution residual stays below 7×10^{-9} and the global wall-flux balance closes to $q_+ + q_- \simeq -1.9\times10^{-7}$, so the coefficient is extracted from a converged stationary state rather than from a finite-time snapshot.

7.5 Independent verification of the Grashof-number scaling

The analytical formulation predicts that the first-order hydrodynamic response is proportional to Gr and therefore that, at fixed (k, Re, Pr),

$$\Pi_T = GrA(k, Re, Pr). \tag{66}$$

This prediction is tested directly with fully nonlinear DNS by varying Gr from zero to 200 while retaining the same geometry, Reynolds number, and thermal parameters.

The DNS gives a practically linear dependence over the investigated range, with a coefficient of determination indistinguishable from unity at the reported numerical precision. In addition, the zero-buoyancy simulation gives

$$\Pi_T(Gr = 0) \simeq -1.1\times10^{-14}, \tag{67}$$

which is numerically zero (Fig. S7).

This result is particularly useful because it validates a structural prediction that is independent of the spatial-parity proof. The symmetry theorem determines the admissible relation between the two wall-flux corrections, while the present DNS confirms independently that the strength of this redistribution is controlled linearly by the buoyancy amplitude at leading order.

7.6 Reynolds-number control at fixed Péclet number

A central consequence of the governing equations is that Pe cannot in general be treated as the sole control parameter for the pumping coefficient. The thermal modal problem depends on $Pe = Re\,Pr$, but the hydrodynamic response retains explicit dependence on Re. The fully nonlinear DNS provides an independent physical test of this distinction.

We therefore keep

$$Pe = 7, \qquad Gr = 100, \qquad k = 0.8 \tag{68}$$

fixed and vary Re, adjusting the Prandtl number according to

$$Pr = \frac{Pe}{Re}. \tag{69}$$

The normalized pumping response obtained from DNS is

Re	Pr	$A_{\mathrm{DNS}} = \Pi_T / Gr$	$\mathrm{sign}(A_{\mathrm{DNS}})$
5	1.4000	-1.5878×10^{-3}	$-$
10	0.7000	-4.6763×10^{-4}	$-$
20	0.3500	-5.9977×10^{-5}	$-$
30	0.2333	$+7.5042 \times 10^{-7}$	$+$
35	0.2000	$+8.9842 \times 10^{-6}$	$+$

(70)

The independent DNS therefore reproduces a clear reversal of the pumping direction. The response is negative at $Re = 20$ but has become positive by $Re = 30$, demonstrating directly that changing the hydrodynamic Reynolds number while preserving the same Pe can reverse the direction of nonlinear thermal pumping (Fig. S8).

The corresponding perturbative values of A at $Re = 5$, 10, 20, and 35 are -1.5951×10^{-3}, -4.7485×10^{-4}, -6.4279×10^{-5}, and $+6.7452 \times 10^{-6}$, respectively. The quantitative agreement is strongest at the lower and intermediate Reynolds numbers, with relative differences of 0.46%, 1.52%, and 6.69% for $Re = 5$, 10, and 20. At $Re = 35$, the relative difference increases to 33.19%; however, both the DNS and perturbative responses are very small in absolute magnitude and have the same positive sign. The discrepancy therefore reflects the sensitivity of a relative error metric near a zero crossing rather than a disagreement in the qualitative pumping mechanism. Near the reversal, the sign of the response is therefore a more robust diagnostic than a relative error normalized by a quantity approaching zero.

The principal physical result of this sweep is thus not the absolute value at $Re = 35$, but the independently confirmed reversal of the pumping direction. This observation supports the analytical conclusion that A is, in general, a function of (k, Re, Pr) and cannot be reduced universally to a function of (k, Pe) alone; Table S4 lists the sweep.

7.7 Independent verification of reflection symmetry and conservation

The exact parity theorem predicts two particularly strong properties that can be tested without comparing the DNS with any perturbative amplitude: (i) reflection of the upper and lower wall amplitudes must reverse the direction of the wall-flux redistribution, and (ii) perfectly symmetric wall forcing must suppress the directional pumping observable.

For the asymmetric reference case, the DNS gives

$$q_+ - q_- = -1.40289979 \times 10^{-5}, \tag{71}$$

whereas after interchanging the upper and lower wall amplitudes,

$$q_+ - q_- = +1.40289979 \times 10^{-5}. \tag{72}$$

The corresponding reflection residual is

$$|D_{\text{reflected}} + D_{\text{baseline}}| = 3.18 \times 10^{-17}. \tag{73}$$

For perfectly symmetric wall forcing, the DNS gives

$$q_+ - q_- = 8.13 \times 10^{-18}, \tag{74}$$

which is indistinguishable from zero at the resolution of the simulation (Fig. 5).

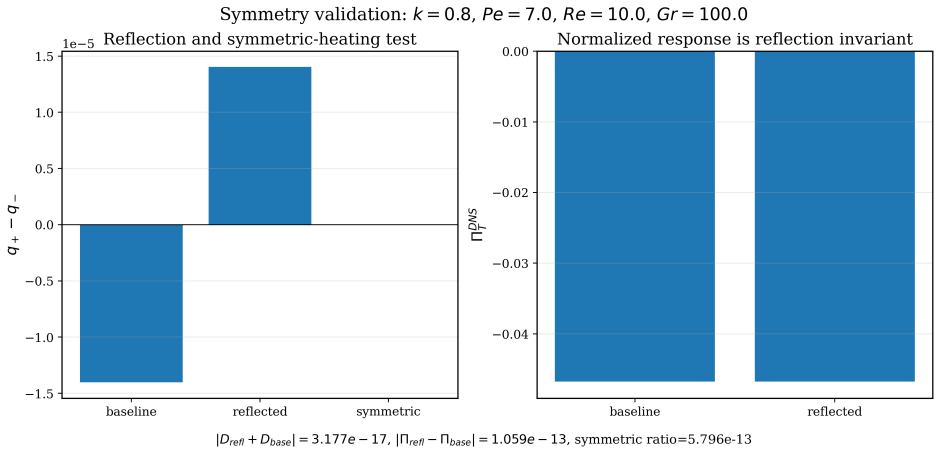


Figure 5: Independent DNS verification of reflection symmetry and wall-flux conservation. Interchanging the upper and lower thermal forcing reverses the sign of the wall-flux difference, whereas perfectly symmetric forcing suppresses the directional redistribution. The measured symmetry residuals are at or below 10^{-13}, with the direct flux-reflection residual reaching 3.18×10^{-17}.

The DNS therefore reproduces the structural symmetry law without explicitly enforc-

ing the analytical parity relations. This is an important distinction: the perturbative derivation proves the selection rule analytically, whereas The nonlinear DNS independently recovers the same reflection-induced reversal of the wall-flux difference and the suppression of directional redistribution under symmetric forcing. Thus, the symmetry-selected structure identified analytically is also observed in the fully coupled nonlinear calculation at finite modulation amplitude.

7.8 Consolidated validation

Figure 6 summarizes the independent numerical evidence. The combination of amplitude extrapolation, spatial refinement, time-step refinement, Grashof-number scaling, Reynolds-number sweeps, reflection tests, and wall-flux conservation provides validation at three complementary levels.

First, the amplitude and resolution studies establish numerical convergence of the nonlinear observable. Second, the Gr and symmetry studies verify the structural consequences of the analytical framework. Third, the fixed-Pe Reynolds sweep provides a genuinely physical result that is not contained in the parity proof alone: the direction of nonlinear pumping can be selected by the hydrodynamic Reynolds number while the thermal Péclet number is unchanged.

For convenience, the principal validation results are collected in Fig. 6 and Table 2. The spatial and temporal entries are reported as differences from the finest calculation in the corresponding convergence sequence; they therefore do not represent formal discretization error bounds.

Table 2: Summary of the independent nonlinear DNS validation campaign. Spatial and temporal convergence values are measured relative to the finest calculation in each sequence. Reflection and symmetric-forcing residuals are absolute numerical residuals.

Test	DNS result	Reference or criterion	Assessment
Amplitude extrapolation	-4.6763×10^{-2}	-4.7485×10^{-2}	1.52% difference
Spatial convergence	$< 1.10\%$	finest-grid limit	converged
Time-step convergence	$< 1.8 \times 10^{-6}$	smallest-Δt limit	converged
Gr scaling	$R^2 \simeq 1$	linearity	confirmed
$Gr = 0$	$\lvert\Pi_T\rvert \simeq 1.1 \times 10^{-14}$	0	confirmed
Reflection flux residual	3.18×10^{-17}	0	confirmed
Reflection Π_T residual	1.06×10^{-13}	0	confirmed
Symmetric forcing residual	5.80×10^{-13}	0	confirmed

Taken together, these calculations provide an independent nonlinear verification of the main analytical conclusions without requiring the DNS to reproduce every perturbative coefficient to arbitrary relative accuracy near a zero crossing. The strongest quantitative agreement occurs away from the reversal region, whereas the vicinity of the reversal is characterized by excellent agreement in the sign and by enhanced sensitivity of the relative error to small absolute differences. This behavior is physically consistent with the

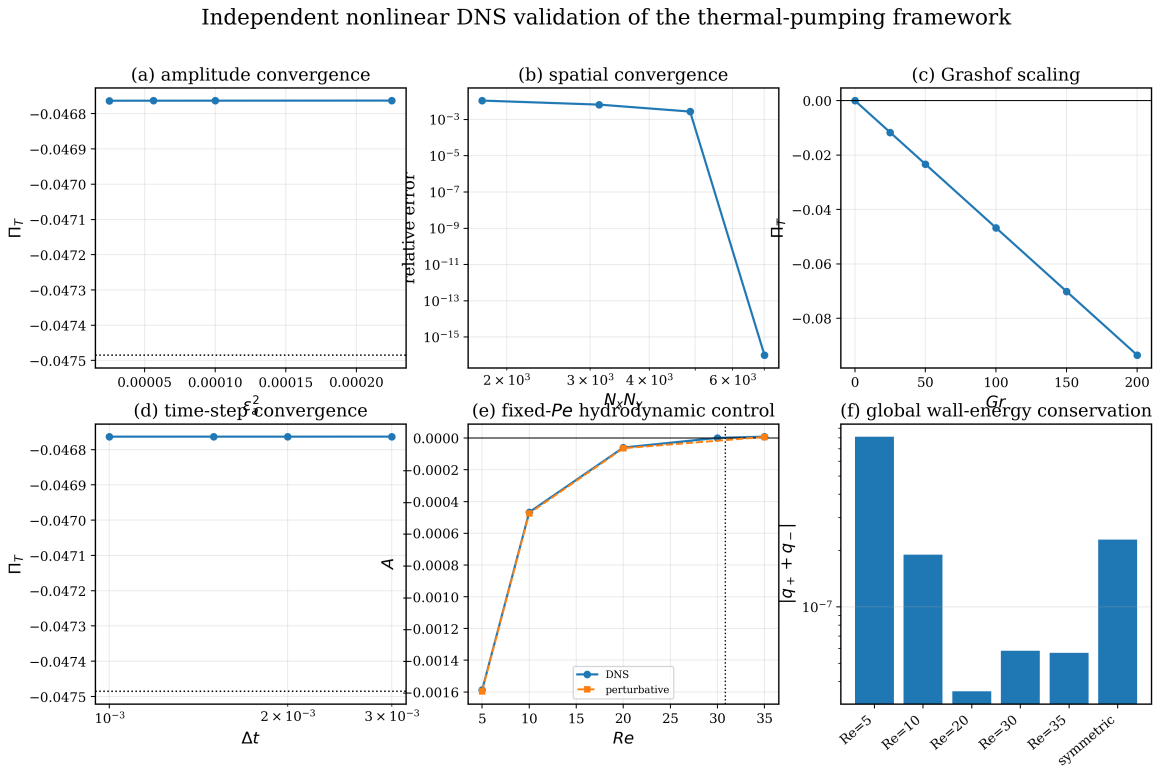


Figure 6: Consolidated summary of the independent nonlinear DNS validation campaign. The seven diagnostic panels combine amplitude extrapolation, spatial and temporal convergence, Grashof-number scaling, fixed-Pe Reynolds dependence, and wall-flux conservation. Together they show that the perturbative thermal-pumping framework is recovered by an independent nonlinear computation and that the Reynolds number remains an active control parameter for the direction of the pumping response.

interpretation of the pumping response as the result of competing thermal–hydrodynamic pathways.

7.9 Physical implication of the nonlinear DNS validation

The DNS results strengthen the physical interpretation of the pumping mechanism by demonstrating that the symmetry-selected wall-flux redistribution is not an artifact of the perturbative truncation. The exact reflection properties survive in the fully nonlinear equations, while the magnitude and direction of the response remain dynamically selectable. In particular, the fixed-Pe Reynolds sweep shows that the thermal field and hydrodynamic mediator should not be viewed as a single reduced transport process: Pe controls the thermal competition between advection and diffusion, whereas Re independently modulates the buoyancy-induced velocity field that transports the asymmetric thermal mode. The observed reversal of Π_T therefore provides a physical signature of competing hydrodynamic pathways underlying the symmetry-selected thermal redistribution.

7.10 Systematic mapping of the Reynolds-number reversal

The reversal reported above is obtained from fully nonlinear DNS at a single wavenumber, and a single point cannot distinguish a law from an accident. We therefore map the reversal locus $Re_c(k)$ with the authoritative perturbative solver over seven wavenumbers at fixed $Pe = 7$ and $Gr = 100$, with $Pr = Pe/Re$, scanning $Re \in \{5, 10, 15, 20, 25, 30, 35, 40\}$ and refining each sign change by Brent iteration. Because the two longest-wavelength crossings fall outside that interval, the scan was extended for $k = 0.4$ and $k = 0.6$ up to $Re = 120$. Section 7.12 confirms this locus nonlinearly: DNS run on both sides of the crossing at four of the seven wavenumbers returns the predicted sign in every case. The complete grid and the seven refined crossings are archived with this paper as group B of the supplementary data package.

Table 3: Reversal Reynolds number at fixed $Pe = 7$ and $Gr = 100$. The five entries with $Re_c \leq 40$ are bracketed inside the primary scan; the two longest-wavelength crossings lie beyond $Re = 40$ and were bracketed on the extended interval. The reversal is therefore resolved at every wavenumber sampled. The $k = 0.8$ value reproduces the independent determination from the DNS-based sweep, $Re_c = 30.838496518$, to nine significant digits.

k	0.4	0.6	0.8	1.0	1.2	1.5	2.0
$Re_c(k)$	79.080214	51.252439	30.838497	20.487029	15.089038	11.069430	8.541316

Two facts follow. First, the reversal is systematic rather than isolated: it occurs at every one of the seven wavenumbers sampled and its location moves monotonically to lower Re as k increases, from $Re_c = 79.08$ at $k = 0.4$ to $Re_c = 8.54$ at $k = 2.0$. Over the seven resolved crossings the empirical description $Re_c \approx 21.50\, k^{-1.47}$ holds with a maximum relative deviation of 11.0%; restricting the fit to the five crossings of the primary $Re \leq 40$ window gives $Re_c \approx 20.91\, k^{-1.41}$ with a maximum deviation of 7.7%, so the two extra points do not follow the same power law as closely as the interior ones. We report both as fits, not as derived scalings, because no exponent has been obtained analytically. Second, the reversal boundary of the (k, Re) plane is not a finite wall at $Re \approx 40$: it recedes toward large Re as k decreases, and at $Gr = 100$ the longest waves reverse only in the low-Pr corner of the (Re, Pr) plane ($Re = 79.08$ and $Pr = 0.089$ at $k = 0.4$). Fig. S2 draws the seven responses whose crossings define that boundary, and Fig. 7 the refined locus with its power-law fit.

7.11 Grashof-independence of the reversal: direct test of Corollary 1

Corollary 1 predicts that the reversal location does not move when the buoyancy amplitude is changed. This is tested at $k = 0.8$, $Pe = 7$ by locating Re_c independently for four Grashof numbers.

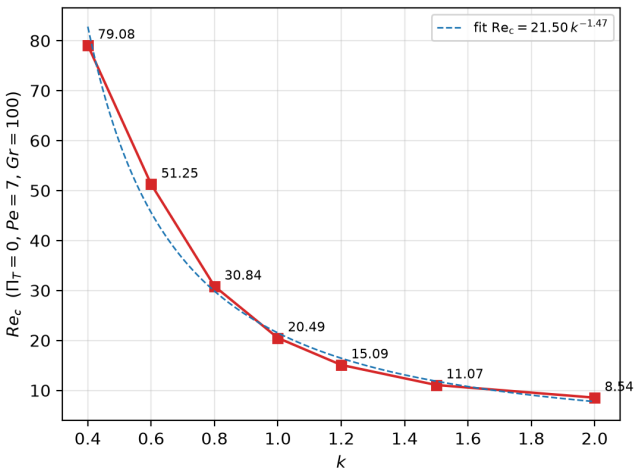


Figure 7: Refined reversal locus $Re_c(k)$ at $Pe = 7$, $Gr = 100$ (Brent iteration on the perturbative solver), resolved at all seven sampled wavenumbers; the dashed line is the seven-point power-law fit $Re_c = 21.50\,k^{-1.47}$. The $k = 0.8$ point coincides with the value previously obtained from the fixed-Pe critical-Reynolds analysis.

Two levels of evidence have to be kept apart here. Within the model, the zero of Π_T is independent of Gr *exactly*: the four locations agree to 1.2×10^{-10} because $\Pi_T/Gr = A(k, Re, Pr)$ is a property of the hydrodynamic and thermal amplitudes and not of the buoyancy amplitude, and the agreement measures the convergence tolerance of the boundary-value solver, not an independent determination of Re_c. The four branches are overlaid in Fig. S3. The same test applied to the quadrature coefficient $\Pi_T^{\perp}$ gives an invariant $\Pi_T^{\perp}/Gr$ to 3.7×10^{-13} over $Gr = 25$–400.

The nonlinear test is narrower in scope: at finite amplitude it checks the proportionality to Gr and the sign of the response at the tested points, not the location of the zero to the perturbative precision. A 2×2 DNS matrix at $k = 0.8$ and $Pe = 7$ pairs $Gr = 50$ with $Gr = 200$ at two Reynolds numbers straddling Re_c, one below and one above. The measured Grashof ratios of $q_+ - q_-$ are 4.0003 at $Re = 20$ and 4.0015 at $Re = 50$, against the exact 4 required by Corollary 1: a worst-case relative error of 3.7×10^{-4}, while the response amplitude itself changes by a factor of four. The sign is unchanged within each pair—negative at $Re = 20$, positive at $Re = 50$—so the reversal does not move when the buoyancy amplitude is quadrupled in the fully nonlinear regime. The offset between DNS and the perturbative coefficient is itself proportional to Gr (the two deviations of a pair differ by 3.996 and 4.015), which is why it rescales the response without displacing its zero: the relative error of $A = \Pi_T/Gr$ is the same at both Grashof numbers, 6.69% at $Re = 20$ and 10.7% at $Re = 50$. The checkpoint record of the four runs, archived as group C of the data package, reduces to Table 4 and to Fig. 8, which draws the same statement as a single branch: the reduced coefficient $A = \Pi_T/Gr$ measured at the two Grashof numbers falls on one curve, and that curve passes through the neighbourhood of the perturbative Re_c. The four DNS points are not themselves an independent determination of Re_c; they

establish that the reduction by Gr removes the buoyancy amplitude from the nonlinear response, which is the statement Corollary 1 makes. The four runs cost 491 s in total, with residuals below 1.0×10^{-8}.

Table 4: Nonlinear test of Corollary 1 at $k = 0.8$, $Pe = 7$, $\varepsilon_s = 0.030$, $\varepsilon_a = 0.005$ and $\phi = 0$, with $Pr = Pe/Re$. Exact linearity in Gr forces the ratio of the two measured flux differences at each Re to equal $200/50 = 4$; the ratios are 4.0003 and 4.0015. The margin column is $|\Pi_T|$ in units of the deviation model δ_Π; the raw record is archived as group C of the data package.

Re	Gr	Pr	$q_+ - q_-$ predicted	measured	margin
20	50	0.3500	-9.641824×10^{-7}	-8.996526×10^{-7}	11.9
20	200	0.3500	-3.856730×10^{-6}	-3.598839×10^{-6}	47.4
50	50	0.1400	$+1.994872 \times 10^{-7}$	$+2.207512 \times 10^{-7}$	2.5
50	200	0.1400	$+7.979489 \times 10^{-7}$	$+8.833327 \times 10^{-7}$	9.8

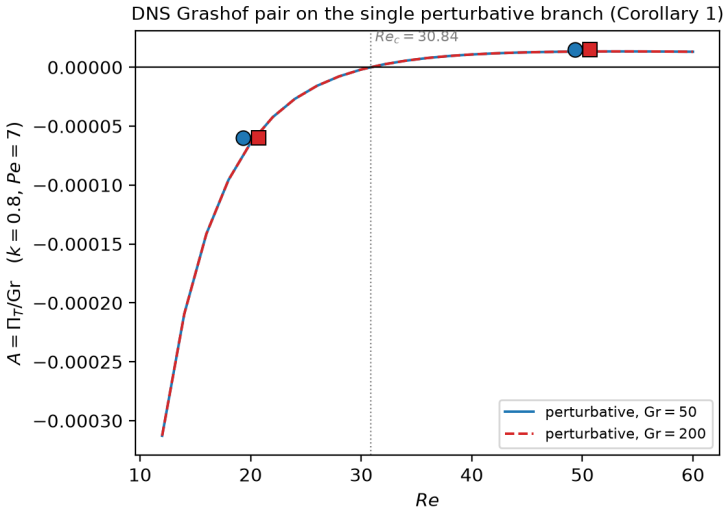


Figure 8: Nonlinear reading of Corollary 1: the reduced coefficient $A = \Pi_T/Gr$ versus Re at $k = 0.8$, $Pe = 7$. The two perturbative branches, $Gr = 50$ (solid) and $Gr = 200$ (dashed), are computed independently and separate by at most 1.1×10^{-10} in relative terms, which is the Gr-independence of A and of its zero $Re_c = 30.84$. The markers are the four DNS measurements of Table 4: circles at $Gr = 50$, squares at $Gr = 200$, offset by ± 0.7 in Re for legibility. Within each pair the two DNS values of A agree to 6.3×10^{-5} ($Re = 20$) and 3.7×10^{-4} ($Re = 50$), so the nonlinear response falls on the same single branch at both buoyancy amplitudes; the branch itself is approached to 6.7% and 10.7%, the deviation analysed in Sec. 7.13. The measured values and the reduced data of the two branches are archived as group C of the data package.

The design is not accidental: candidate Reynolds numbers closer to the crossing were rejected before integration by the resolvability gate of Sec. 7.13, which requires the predicted signal to exceed the deviation floor by more than a factor of two. The pair $Re = 32$ has margins 0.43 and 1.72 and the pair $Re = 40$ has 1.99 and 7.98, so in both cases at

least one member cannot test a sign; the accepted pair keeps margins between 2.5 and 47.4 on both sides of Re_c.

The residual departures of the two measured ratios from exactly four—0.1% and 0.4%—are not interpreted. A Richardson-type correction Gr/Re^2 would predict the larger departure at the smaller Reynolds number, since $Gr/Re^2 = 0.50$ for $(Gr, Re) = (200, 20)$ against 0.08 for $(200, 50)$, whereas the observed ordering is the reverse. The ratios are therefore reported as consistent with exact Grashof linearity at the tolerance the runs reach, and the structural claim rests on the proportionality of the *discrepancy* together with the unchanged sign, not on the fourth decimal of the ratio.

7.12 Fully nonlinear DNS confirmation

The perturbative campaign is complete and every claim in Sections 5–7.10 is backed by the second-order solver. The thirteen DNS runs designed to test the same claims nonlinearly were executed with the mesh, time step and integration length already validated in Table 2 ($N_x = 64$, $N_y = 49$, $\Delta t = 1.5 \times 10^{-3}$, 3×10^4 steps): 90–144 s per case, 24.8 min in total, with final residuals below 2.2×10^{-8}. Each entry of Table 5 is therefore a measured flux difference compared with the two-coefficient phase law evaluated at the stated wall amplitudes,

$$q_+ - q_- = 2Nu_{2,0}(+1) = 2\big(c\,\Pi_T + d\,\Pi_T^{\perp}\big), \qquad c = \Re\big(\widehat{\varepsilon}_a\widehat{\varepsilon}_s^{*}\big), \quad d = \Im\big(\widehat{\varepsilon}_a\widehat{\varepsilon}_s^{*}\big), \tag{75}$$

with $\widehat{\varepsilon}_s = \frac{1}{2}(\varepsilon_1 + \varepsilon_2 e^{-i\phi})$ and $\widehat{\varepsilon}_a = \frac{1}{2}(\varepsilon_1 - \varepsilon_2 e^{-i\phi})$, and with $\Pi_T(k, Re)$, $\Pi_T^{\perp}(k, Re)$ from the same authoritative solver.

The forcing amplitudes are $\varepsilon_1 = \varepsilon_s + \varepsilon_a$ and $\varepsilon_2 = \varepsilon_s - \varepsilon_a$ with $\varepsilon_s = 0.03$ and $\varepsilon_a = 0.005$ throughout, except for the ladder run D3L, which raises ε_a to 0.02 at fixed ε_s, and for the D5 family, which uses equal amplitudes $\varepsilon_1 = \varepsilon_2 = 0.03$ with a phase lag ϕ.

1. *Reversal confirmed at four wavenumbers.* The locus $Re_c(k)$ of Table 3 is perturbative, so each wavenumber is tested on both sides of its own crossing rather than on a common Reynolds interval: at $k = 0.6$ the reversal sits at $Re = 51.25$, and a grid confined to $Re \le 40$ would sample a single sign at that wavenumber and measure nothing about a reversal. All eight bracket runs return the predicted sign, and the two members of every pair return opposite signs. The reversal of the pumping direction with Re at fixed Pe is therefore a nonlinear result, not an artefact of the second-order truncation.

2. *Control point away from the crossing.* The relative deviation of the earlier DNS comparison was largest near $Re = 35$, where Π_T approaches zero and a fixed absolute error maps onto a large relative one. At $Re = 50$ the measured coefficient is $+1.472 \times 10^{-3}$ against $+1.330 \times 10^{-3}$ predicted: the sign is unambiguous and the absolute

Table 5: DNS measurements against the two-coefficient prediction ($Pe = 7$, $Gr = 100$, $Pr = Pe/Re$). The first two result columns are wall-flux differences, $q_+ - q_-$; the last column is the same comparison divided by the bilinear factor and expressed in coefficient space, $|\Pi_T^{\mathrm{DNS}} - \Pi_T^{\mathrm{pred}}| = |\Delta(q_+ - q_-)|/(2|\widehat{\varepsilon}_a\widehat{\varepsilon}_s^*|)$. The conversion factor is $2|\widehat{\varepsilon}_a\widehat{\varepsilon}_s^*| = 3.0 \times 10^{-4}$ for the D3, D3b and D4 families, 1.2×10^{-3} for the ladder run D3L and 9.0×10^{-4} for the D5 quadrature runs; the ladder flux gap of 3.25×10^{-7} is therefore the coefficient-space deviation 2.71×10^{-4} quoted for it. The parity run has $\widehat{\varepsilon}_a = 0$ and no coefficient-space statement is possible. The bound column is the deviation model $\delta_\Pi = \max(2.71 \times 10^{-4}, 1.52\%\,|\Pi_T|)$ pre-registered from the completed fixed-Pe sweep, and $\leq$ marks where it holds. The single measured sign that differs from the prediction, marked [a], is the ladder run discussed in item 3 of Section 7.12.

case	purpose	Re	Pr	ϕ	$q_+ - q_-$ predicted	measured	dev. in Π_T
D3	bracket at $k = 0.8$	20	0.3500	0	-1.928365×10^{-6}	-1.799329×10^{-6}	4.30×10^{-4}, $1.6\delta_\Pi$
D3	bracket at $k = 0.8$	40	0.1750	0	$+3.242275 \times 10^{-7}$	$+3.809729 \times 10^{-7}$	1.89×10^{-4}, $\leq \delta_\Pi$
D3	bracket at $k = 1.0$	15	0.4667	0	-1.828239×10^{-6}	-1.604171×10^{-6}	7.47×10^{-4}, $2.8\delta_\Pi$
D3	bracket at $k = 1.0$	25	0.2800	0	$+4.671537 \times 10^{-7}$	$+5.910363 \times 10^{-7}$	4.13×10^{-4}, $1.5\delta_\Pi$
D3	bracket at $k = 1.2$	10	0.7000	0	-3.702864×10^{-6}	-3.326895×10^{-6}	1.25×10^{-3}, $4.6\delta_\Pi$
D3	bracket at $k = 1.2$	20	0.3500	0	$+7.719747 \times 10^{-7}$	$+9.454173 \times 10^{-7}$	5.78×10^{-4}, $2.1\delta_\Pi$
D3	bracket at $k = 0.6$	40	0.1750	0	-3.886322×10^{-7}	-3.542744×10^{-7}	1.15×10^{-4}, $\leq \delta_\Pi$
D3	bracket at $k = 0.6$	70	0.1000	0	$+1.740707 \times 10^{-7}$	$+1.910334 \times 10^{-7}$	5.66×10^{-5}, $\leq \delta_\Pi$
D3L	crossing ladder	30	0.2333	0	-2.350614×10^{-7}	$+9.007819 \times 10^{-8}$ [a]	2.71×10^{-4}, $\leq \delta_\Pi$
D4	control, far side	50	0.1400	0	$+3.989744 \times 10^{-7}$	$+4.416458 \times 10^{-7}$	1.42×10^{-4}, $\leq \delta_\Pi$
D5	parity cancellation	10	0.7000	0	exactly 0	$+3.14 \times 10^{-18}$	—
D5	quadrature pumping	10	0.7000	$+\pi/2$	$+8.005465 \times 10^{-5}$	$+8.115924 \times 10^{-5}$	1.23×10^{-3}, $\leq \delta_\Pi$
D5	reversed quadrature	10	0.7000	$-\pi/2$	-8.005465×10^{-5}	-8.115932×10^{-5}	1.23×10^{-3}, $\leq \delta_\Pi$

deviation, 1.42×10^{-4}, is half the pre-registered floor. The large relative error near the crossing is thus a crossing artefact.

3. *Error-model discriminator.* The ladder run D3L was designed to separate the two readings of δ_Π. Raising ε_a fourfold multiplies the flux gap, 3.25×10^{-7} against the 1.29×10^{-7} measured at the reference amplitude and the nearest bracket point of the same wavenumber ($k = 0.8$, $Re = 20$), but leaves the coefficient-space deviation at 2.709×10^{-4}—that is 1.00 times the absolute floor—and the measured sign is positive where the prediction is negative. The deviation is therefore *not* absolute in $q_+ - q_-$ and does not improve with the forcing amplitude: the coefficient-space reading is the correct one, and a single-amplitude DNS test of this family cannot resolve the reversal once $|\Pi_T| \lesssim \delta_\Pi$.

4. *Quadrature coefficient.* The equal-amplitude, phase-shifted runs measure, at $\phi = \pi/2$, the value $Nu_{2,0}(+1) = +4.0580 \times 10^{-5}$, and at $\phi = -\pi/2$ the opposite -4.0580×10^{-5}, against $+4.003 \times 10^{-5}$ and -4.003×10^{-5} predicted: a relative deviation of 1.38% and an antisymmetry residual of 8.0×10^{-11}, i.e. 9.9×10^{-7} of the signal. The existence and the sign reversal of $\Pi_T^{\perp}$ are thus confirmed nonlinearly, and with them Corollary 2. The $\phi = 0$ member of the same family is the exact cancellation limit: the two wall fluxes are measured equal to 3.1×10^{-18}, against individual values of $-1.145796985 \times 10^{-7}$, so the parity theorem is reproduced in DNS at a relative precision of 2.7×10^{-11}—eleven digits beyond the flux itself. This is the sharpest

single confirmation in the campaign, and it is independent of the symmetric-forcing case of Table 2 at 8×10^{-18}.

Fig. 9 collects the two readings of the same campaign: the reversal direction, panel (a), and the magnitude against the pre-registered deviation model, panel (b), which is the quantity the analysis of Sec. 7.13 judges.

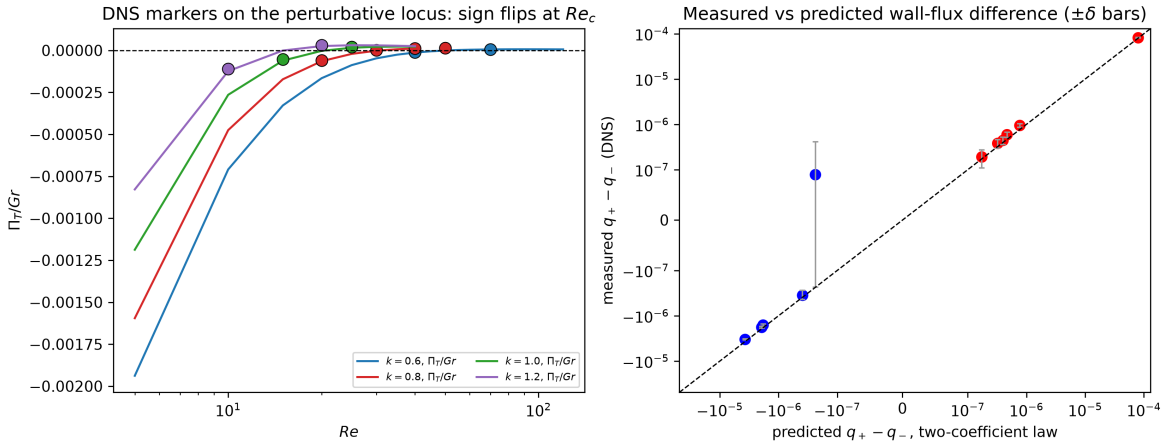


Figure 9: (a) Measured pumping coefficient divided by Gr (markers) against the perturbative locus (lines) at the four wavenumbers bracketed by DNS; every marker pair straddles its own Re_c with opposite sign. This panel tests the direction of the reversal. (b) Measured versus predicted wall-flux difference for the twelve non-degenerate runs, with error bars $2|\widehat{\varepsilon}_a \widehat{\varepsilon}_s^*|\delta_\Pi$. This panel tests the magnitude, and is the one the error model of Sec. 7.13 is judged against. Eleven of the twelve lie on the predicted side of zero; the outlier is the ladder run, the single case whose margin was below unity before the campaign was launched.

7.13 What the campaign changes about the error model

The campaign falsifies part of its own pre-registered error model. Of the twelve non-degenerate cases, seven satisfy $\delta_\Pi = \max(2.71 \times 10^{-4}, 1.52\%\,|\Pi_T|)$ and five exceed it, by up to 4.6 times. The pattern is systematic rather than random: the coefficient-space deviation is independent of the forcing amplitude (item 3 above) and grows monotonically with the wavenumber, its maximum over the bracket pairs rising from 1.15×10^{-4} at $k = 0.6$ through 4.30×10^{-4} at $k = 0.8$ and 7.47×10^{-4} at $k = 1.0$ to 1.25×10^{-3} at $k = 1.2$. Two consequences follow. First, the 1.52% figure quoted for the reference case is specific to $(k, Re) = (0.8, 10)$, where $|\Pi_T|$ is large; near a crossing the relevant quantity is the absolute offset, not a relative one. Second, a DNS test of the reversal at wavenumber k is meaningful only for $|\Pi_T(k, Re)| \gtrsim \delta_\Pi(k)$, which the bracket design of item 1 satisfies in every pair except the ladder run.

8 Physical Interpretation and Discussion

8.1 Quantitative phase analysis of the reversal

The reversal must be explained, not merely reported. Because the mean thermal problem and the wall-flux functional $\mathcal{L}[\cdot]$ are linear, the four terms of the mixed forcing (S38) contribute additively to Π_T:

$$\Pi_T = \mathcal{L}\big[\langle V^{(a)}\partial_Y\Theta^{(s)}\rangle\big] + \mathcal{L}\big[\langle U^{(a)}\partial_X\Theta^{(s)}\rangle\big] + \mathcal{L}\big[\langle V^{(s)}\partial_Y\Theta^{(a)}\rangle\big] + \mathcal{L}\big[\langle U^{(s)}\partial_X\Theta^{(a)}\rangle\big], \quad (76)$$

where $\langle\cdot\rangle$ denotes streamwise averaging and each term is evaluated with the other mode at unit amplitude. Eq. (76) is an identity, not a model: evaluating the four functionals separately reproduces the full Π_T with a maximum absolute deviation of 1.4×10^{-14} over the whole Re scan (the relative deviation reaches 1.6×10^{-5} only at $Re = Re_c$, where Π_T itself vanishes; Table S5).

Three conclusions follow, and one common expectation is disproved.

1. **The reversal is a magnitude race, not a phase flip.** The ratio of the two dominant contributions, $\big|\mathcal{L}[\langle V^{(a)}\partial_Y\Theta^{(s)}\rangle]\big|/\mathcal{L}[\langle U^{(a)}\partial_X\Theta^{(s)}\rangle]$, falls monotonically over the whole scan, from 3.40 at $Re = 5$ through 1.012 at the reversal itself to 0.936 at $Re = 50$. Neither term changes sign anywhere in the scan; only their relative size does.

2. **The subdominant terms are not negligible at the crossing.** The two-term balance alone would predict the reversal at $Re = 32.713$, whereas the full sum crosses at $Re_c = 30.838$; the difference of 1.88 in Re (6.1%) is caused by the two symmetric-velocity terms, whose net contribution is $+2.7\times10^{-4}$ at the crossing—about 1.2% of the dominant terms but the entire residual that decides the sign. Any two-term explanation of the reversal is therefore quantitatively wrong.

3. **The phase lags are smooth and never cross zero.** The unwrapped centreline lag between the antisymmetric velocity and thermal modes, $\Delta\varphi^{(a)}(0) = \arg\big(\widehat{V}^{(a)}/\Theta^{(a)}\big)$, increases monotonically from -2.154 to -1.532 rad over $Re \in [5, 50]$ and passes through no sign change; the symmetric-mode lag $\Delta\varphi^{(s)}(0)$ is non-monotonic. The local overlap factor of the sweep term stays close to unity ($0.993 \to 0.878$), i.e. that term remains nearly in phase, whereas the streamwise overlap factor oscillates about zero because of the nodes of the two modes. A narrative in which the reversal "coincides with a phase crossing" is not supported by these measurements; the correct statement is that the reversal coincides with the zero of the weighted overlap *sum* (76).

Physically, decreasing $Pr = Pe/Re$ at fixed Pe thins the thermal response relative

to the velocity response, which weakens the transverse sweep production of the odd forcing faster than it weakens the streamwise-advection production. Once the two contributions become comparable, the small antisymmetric-velocity terms decide the sign, and the pumping direction reverses. This is the sense in which the dynamics, and not the symmetry, select the direction. Fig. S9 separates the two readings: the four additive contributions on top, and on the bottom the unwrapped phase lags, which cross zero nowhere and so rule out a phase mechanism.

8.2 Physical realization of the symmetry-selected pumping mechanism

The resolved two-dimensional reference solution $(k, Pe, Re, Pr, Gr) = (0.8, 7, 10, 0.7, 100)$ makes the transport pathway visible, and it carries the selection rule in the form the analysis predicts. Three features of that solution are needed for the argument, and all three are documented in Sec. S4 of the supplementary material: the temperature field, whose cross-channel mean correction $\theta_{2,0}(Y)$ is odd and vanishes at the channel centreline (Supplementary Fig. S15); the buoyancy-driven transverse velocity modes that convert the thermal pair into a momentum flux (Supplementary Figs. S11 and S12); and the point-by-point parity classification of the quadratic forcing, which shows that every term of $\mathcal{E}_{as}$ is odd while each of the two wall contributions is separately non-zero (Supplementary Figs. S13 and S14). The reading is therefore not that the two walls stop exchanging heat, but that the nonlinear interaction is symmetry-forbidden from rectifying into a net transport: the pumping is selected, not suppressed. Buoyancy then enters only as the amplitude mediator, which is why the direction of the response is set by Re rather than by Gr.

8.3 Mechanism: buoyancy-mediated spatial rectification

The mechanism is a two-stage process. The boundary asymmetry creates simultaneous symmetric and antisymmetric thermal modes; buoyancy converts them into transverse velocity modes, and the resulting velocity–temperature products generate the odd second-order forcing, whose magnitude carries the linear factor Gr. The content of that forcing is most compactly stated as a pair of moment conditions,

$$\int_{-1}^{1} \mathcal{E}_{as}(Y)\, dY = 0, \qquad \int_{-1}^{1} Y\, \mathcal{E}_{as}(Y)\, dY \neq 0, \tag{77}$$

which is what makes the channel a *transverse spatial rectifier*: the zeroth moment cancels by parity, so no net mean thermal energy is generated, while the first transverse moment survives and is converted directly into the measurable wall-flux difference by the Green identity Eq. (41). The selection theorem fixes which wall-flux combinations are admissible;

the coupled transport problem fixes how strongly and in which direction the admissible redistribution occurs. That division of labour is why the reversal near $Re_c \simeq 30.84$ at fixed Pe reports a change of the hydrodynamic pathway and not of the thermal forcing class. Two limits carry the same reading: the $O(k^2)$ suppression of the rectified moment as the wall pattern becomes slowly varying, and the finite-domain endpoint of the zero-crossing branch, where the zero set leaves the admissible domain rather than losing stability. Table S6 of the supplementary material states the contrast with the symmetry-preserving forcing term by term, and the field maps, the secondary circulation and the detailed spatial analysis of both limits are developed in Sec. S4.6 of the supplementary material.

8.4 What is exact and what is dynamical?

Three different statements must be distinguished. First, the relation $Nu_{2,0}(+1) = -Nu_{2,0}(-1)$ is an exact consequence of reflection symmetry, uniqueness, and the mixed symmetric–antisymmetric interaction. Second, the magnitude and sign of Π_T are not fixed by symmetry and depend on the coupled thermal–hydrodynamic dynamics. Third, the value $Pe_c = 10.871940554611$ reached here is not a universal critical Péclet number: it is the value at which the observed zero set reaches the imposed finite boundary $k = 10$ for the particular fixed-Reynolds-number problem considered here.

The dense CPU calculation strengthens this distinction. Below the endpoint, an interior zero exists; at the endpoint, the zero is located at the boundary; above the endpoint, no positive response remains in the investigated wavenumber interval. Thus, the transition concerns the geometry of the zero set in a finite parameter domain rather than the onset of a new symmetry class or a hydrodynamic instability.

8.5 Limitations

The analysis is restricted to the Boussinesq approximation, a two-dimensional laminar base state, a single spatial Fourier harmonic, and small modulation amplitudes $\varepsilon \ll 1$ for which the second-order expansion is asymptotically consistent. The finite-domain statement for Pe_c is also explicitly restricted to $0.02 \leq k \leq 10$ and $Re = 10$, $Gr = 100$. The nonlinear evidence reported in Section 7 is a stationary DNS of the full equations at the tested amplitudes; extending it to larger wall amplitudes, to higher harmonics and to wider ranges of (k, Pe, Re, Gr) would require additional DNS over those domains, which is where the finite-amplitude corrections, the higher harmonics and any secondary instability would have to be quantified.

8.6 Generalization to phase-shifted wall forcing

The phase-shifted forcing family is treated in full in Section 5, where it is shown to introduce a second, independent pumping coefficient $\Pi_T^{\perp}$ and to reproduce a pure $\sin\phi$ dependence for equal wall amplitudes (Corollary 2).

8.7 What drives the growth of the remainder with k

The monotone growth is the interesting part of the table, and it has two candidate causes that this campaign does not separate. The first is physical: the second-order truncation neglects harmonics $2k$ and $3k$ and the wall-normal gradients grow with k, so a higher-order remainder is expected to increase with the wavenumber. The deviation grows monotonically with k over the four resolved wavenumbers, and a log–log fit of the eight bracket runs gives $|\Delta\Pi_T| \propto k^{3.4\pm1.7}$ at $R^2 = 0.84$ over the narrow span $k = 0.6$–1.2. That exponent is not statistically sharp enough to discriminate between candidate higher-order mechanisms, so the growth is reported as an empirical observation and not as a scaling law: no power of k enters any subsequent argument of this paper, and the separation of the growth from the mesh-resolution floor is identified as future work below. The second candidate is numerical, and it cannot be dismissed by the residuals alone. The time-stepping and solver errors are genuinely negligible—the final residuals are below 2.2×10^{-8}, four orders under the deviations they accompany—but the spatial discretisation is not: on the published convergence ladder at $k = 0.8$, Π_T moves by 3.1×10^{-4} between the production mesh of 3136 degrees of freedom and the finest tested, 7008, which is the same order as the deviations measured here at $k = 0.8$ and $k = 1.0$. Because the mesh is held at $N_x = 64$ while the wavelength shrinks, a truncation error of this kind predicts precisely the observed growth with k.

Two observations narrow the field. The deviation is amplitude-independent at fixed k (item 3), whereas a genuine higher power of the forcing would scale with ε^2; the remainder is therefore either a mesh effect or a k-dependent contribution that does not multiply $\widehat{\varepsilon}_a\widehat{\varepsilon}_s^*$, such as the feedback of the second-order mean field on the base temperature gradient. And the growth is confined to the comparison with the perturbative coefficient: the *sign* structure, which is what the paper claims, is recovered in all eight bracket pairs. A decisive separation requires one replica of the $k = 1.2$ pair at refined N_x: if the deviation collapses toward the floor, the growth is discretisation; if it persists, it is the remainder of the truncation. That test is identified as future work rather than asserted here.

Grashof-independence of the reversal point (Corollary 1) is exact within the perturbative model, to better than 10^{-9} in Re_c, and the nonlinear evidence concerns the two claims that DNS can actually test at these amplitudes: DNS at the Grashof pair $(Gr, Re) = (50, 20)$, $(200, 20)$, $(50, 50)$, $(200, 50)$ returns Grashof ratios 4.0003 and 4.0015 with the predicted sign preserved in both pairs (Sec. 7.11). The DNS points do not

relocate Re_c at the perturbative precision, and are not presented as doing so.

9 Conclusions

This study separates what reflection symmetry forces from what the coupled thermal–hydrodynamic dynamics choose. The organizing result is that the *structure* of the nonlinear wall-flux redistribution is fixed exactly by symmetry, whereas its *amplitude and sign* are dynamical, and that the Reynolds number—even at fixed Péclet number—controls the direction of the resulting thermal pumping.

What symmetry selects. The first-order thermal fields decompose uniquely into symmetric and antisymmetric parts; their hydrodynamic responses inherit opposite reflection parities, so the mixed quadratic forcing is necessarily odd across the channel. The second-order mean temperature correction is therefore odd, which imposes

$$\boxed{Nu_{2,0}(+1) = -Nu_{2,0}(-1)} \tag{78}$$

This is a structural consequence of the governing equations *within the second-order expansion*: it concerns the mixed quadratic contribution to the mean wall flux, and it is independent of the size of that contribution, so it holds whether the pumping amplitude is large, small or zero. It is not a claim that the identity has been established at arbitrary wall amplitude by the perturbative theory. The finite-amplitude DNS value quoted above is a separate numerical verification of the same cancellation, and it is presented as such.

What the dynamics select. The redistribution is measured by the thermal-pumping coefficient, for which the Green identity $\Pi_T = -(Pe/2)\int_{-1}^{1} Y\,\mathcal{E}_{as}\,dY$ yields

$$\Pi_T = Gr\,A(k, Re, Pr), \qquad A(k, Re, Pr) = O(k^2) \;\text{ as }\; k \to 0. \tag{79}$$

Linearity in Gr separates the buoyancy amplitude from the response, and the long-wavelength limit shows that a slowly varying wall pattern cannot drive the effect. Under the hypotheses of the model, Π_T is proportional to Gr, so its zero is exactly independent of Gr (Corollary 1): the reversal point is $Re_c = 30.8384965$ for $Gr = 25, 50, 100$ and 200, with an absolute spread of 1.2×10^{-10} and A invariant to better than 10^{-10} relative — a solver tolerance, not an independent nonlinear measurement of Re_c. DNS tests the two statements that remain at finite amplitude: at $Re = 20$ and $Re = 50$ the measured Grashof ratio of $q_+ - q_-$ is 4.0003 and 4.0015, and the sign predicted on either side of the crossing survives.

Phase selects a second, independent coefficient. Allowing a phase lag ϕ between the two walls makes the mixed product complex, and streamwise averaging leaves two independent

invariants rather than one. The wall flux becomes

$$Nu_{2,0}(+1) = \Re(\varepsilon_a \varepsilon_s^*)\,\Pi_T + \Im(\varepsilon_a \varepsilon_s^*)\,\Pi_T^{\perp}, \tag{80}$$

with $\Pi_T = -4.74850846 \times 10^{-2}$ and $\Pi_T^{\perp} = +8.89496095 \times 10^{-2}$ at the reference state: the quadrature coefficient is of opposite sign and nearly twice as large. For equal wall amplitudes the in-phase invariant vanishes identically and the response obeys $Nu_{2,0}(+1) \propto \sin\phi$ exactly (Corollary 2), verified phase by phase to 2.4×10^{-13}. This is a selection rule, not a suggestion: it fixes which combinations of wall forcing can pump and in which quadrature.

Reversal is systematic, and it is a magnitude race, not a phase flip. The reversal point has been mapped over seven wavenumbers, giving Re_c from 79.08 at $k = 0.4$ to 8.54 at $k = 2.0$; the reversal is resolved at every wavenumber sampled, and its locus follows $Re_c \approx 21.50\,k^{-1.47}$ to within 11% over that range. The DNS confirms the reversal at the reference wavenumber: $\Pi_T^{\mathrm{DNS}} = -4.6763 \times 10^{-2}$, 1.52% from the perturbative -4.7485×10^{-2}, with the sign change between $Re = 20$ and $Re = 30$ at fixed $Pe = 7$ reproduced nonlinearly, and at three further wavenumbers: all eight runs that bracket Re_c at $k = 0.6$, 0.8, 1.0 and 1.2 return the predicted sign, and the quadrature coefficient is measured to 1.38% (Sec. 7.12). The term-wise decomposition of Π_T shows what does *not* happen: the antisymmetric wall-normal transport term never crosses zero and the unwrapped phase lag $\Delta\varphi^{(a)}$ increases monotonically from -2.154 to -1.532 rad across the reversal. The sign change arises because the magnitudes of the advective and wall-normal contributions become comparable ($|T_{Va}|/|T_{Ua}|$ falls from 3.40 to 0.936), with the subdominant symmetric terms deciding the crossing to within 6%.

Independent nonlinear evidence. DNS confirms the Grashof scaling $\Pi_T \propto Gr$ with a coefficient of determination effectively equal to unity and a vanishing response at $Gr = 0$, recovers the reflection identity $\Pi_T(\varepsilon_1, \varepsilon_2) = -\Pi_T(\varepsilon_2, \varepsilon_1)$, and reproduces the exact cancellation of the parity limit: at equal wall amplitudes and $\phi = 0$ the two measured wall fluxes agree to 3.1×10^{-18}, against individual fluxes of 1.15×10^{-7}, a relative precision of 2.7×10^{-11}. On the Grashof pair of Sec. 7.11 the nonlinear correction is itself proportional to Gr, so it rescales the coefficient without shifting its zero at the tested amplitudes. The exactness of the zero remains a statement of the perturbative model (Corollary 1); the DNS campaign verifies its two observable consequences, not the location itself. Spatial and temporal refinement demonstrate convergence of the nonlinear observable. The campaign also falsifies part of its own pre-registered error model: five of the twelve non-degenerate cases exceed δ_Π, with an excess that is independent of the forcing amplitude and grows with the wavenumber (Sec. 8.7); separating the truncation remainder from the residual spatial discretisation requires a refined-N_x replica of the $k = 1.2$ bracket pair, which is the immediate next test. The remaining finite-domain statement $Pe_c = 10.871940554611$

is the value at which the zero set of $\Pi_T(k, Pe)$ leaves the imposed interval $0.02 \leq k \leq 10$ at $Re = 10$; it is a property of the window, not an instability threshold.

Future work should extend the present approach beyond the two-dimensional laminar setting: larger modulation amplitudes, three-dimensional configurations and turbulent mixed convection. The most immediate testable consequence of the two-coefficient law is the quadrature prediction of Section 7.12—equal-amplitude forcing at $\phi = \pi/2$ gives $Nu_{2,0}(+1) = +4.0580\times10^{-5}$ in DNS against $+4.003\times10^{-5}$ predicted, whereas the in-phase-dominated forcing used in the earlier validation gives -7.123×10^{-6}; the two cases differ only in $\Im(\varepsilon_a \varepsilon_s^*)$. Wall-temperature phase and amplitude asymmetry therefore constitute a control knob for the direction of thermal pumping, with the Reynolds number setting where the knob changes sign.

Supplementary Material

The derivations, the verification records, the parameter maps and the field structures that support this article are collected in a separate Supplementary Material document, compiled independently and numbered throughout with the prefix **S**, so that its figures, tables, equations and section numbers cannot be confused with those of the manuscript. It contains six sections: Sec. S1, perturbative parameter maps and scaling checks; Sec. S2, nonlinear DNS verification and convergence, which carries the amplitude, grid and time-step sequences Sec. S2.1 summarises; Sec. S3, phase decomposition and term-wise balance; Sec. S4, physical structure of the symmetry-selected pumping mechanism, which includes the spatial rectification analysis of Sec. 8.3; Sec. S5, derivations and independent numerical checks; and Sec. S6, construction of the two independent mixed kernels. Every figure and table of that document is cited from the manuscript, and the pointers in the text read "Sec. S#.# of the supplementary material".

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Disclosure statement

The author reports no potential conflict of interest.

Author contributions

The author conceived and designed the study, derived the theory, implemented the numerical methods, ran every verification and direct-numerical-simulation campaign, processed the data, prepared the figures, tables and the data package, and wrote and edited the manuscript.

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Data availability

All numerical data supporting this study, together with the manuscript source, the supplementary document, the scripts of the verification campaigns, the figures and this article's data package, are openly deposited in a public repository at the address

`https://github.com/Ahmedalgeria778/symmetry_selected_thermal_pumping`

The supplementary document carries the derivations and the supporting floats cited from the text and numbered with an **S**; the data package itself gathers 64 files, documented item by item and inventoried with the size, line count and SHA-256 digest of every entry. Group A of that package holds the dense Pe survey behind Fig. 4; group B the perturbative reversal and phase campaigns of Secs. 7.10 and 5; group C the nonlinear DNS results of Sec. 6.2, including the pre-run predictions, the raw per-case measurements, the derived deviation table and the analysis summary of the confirmation campaign of Sec. 7.12, the four-run Grashof-pair matrix of Sec. 7.11 and the reduced data behind Fig. 8; and group D the boundary-value, shooting and analysis scripts that regenerate every table and figure of this paper from the raw records. The DNS matrix runs from a single driver that performs a dry run unless an explicit go-ahead flag is supplied and resumes from its own checkpoint. The package inventory maps each figure and table of the paper to the files that produce it.

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